

RANK TWO COHOMOLOGY JUMP LOCI ON PROJECTIVE VARIETIES

QUOC ANH TRAN

ABSTRACT. Let X be a smooth connected complex projective variety. We give a structure theorem for irreducible components of the rank two cohomology jump loci on X . More precisely, for such a component Z , if the general point of Z is virtually abelian, then either Z is a symmetric square of an algebraic torus, or a quotient of a torus by an involution, or its normalization Z^ν is a torus. If the general point is not virtually abelian, then either Z^ν is a torus, or an étale quotient of $Q^\nu \times T$ where Q is an irreducible component of the character variety of some DM-curve.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Let X be a smooth projective variety, and

$$\begin{aligned} R_B(X, x, r) &:= \text{Hom}(\pi_1(X, x), \text{GL}_r) \\ \mathcal{M}_B(X, r) &:= [R_B(X, x, r)/\text{GL}_r] \\ M_B(X, r) &:= R_B(X, x, r)//\text{GL}_r \end{aligned}$$

be, respectively, the moduli of framed local systems, the quotient stack, and the GIT quotient/good moduli space for the stack. We have the cohomology jump loci

$$\Sigma_k^i(X, x, r) := \left\{ \mathbb{V} \in R_B(X, x, r) \mid \dim H^i(X, \mathbb{V}) \geq k \right\}$$

which is GL_r -invariant hence descends to a substack $\Sigma_k^i(X, r) \subset \mathcal{M}_B(X, r)$. Denote $\bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, r)$ its reduced image in $M_B(X, r)$.

1.1. Hodge structures on jump loci.

Theorem 1.1 (Theorem 3.9). *For smooth projective X , the jump locus $\Sigma_k^i(X, x, r) \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$ is a Hodge subvariety. Furthermore, it is closed under semisimplification, and $\Sigma_k^i(X, r)_{\text{red}}$ is a Hodge subvariety which is absolute $\mathbb{Q}$ -closed.*

Every irreducible component of $\Sigma_k^i(X, r)_{\text{red}}$ is a Hodge subvariety and is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed.

In particular, at a VHS point $\mathbb{V} \in \Sigma_k^i(X, x, r)$ there is a pro-MHS-algebra structure on $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{\Sigma_k^i(X, x, r), \mathbb{V}}$. We prove that there are compatible pro-MHS-algebra structures on both the good moduli image $\bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, r) \subseteq M_B(X, r)$ (by Proposition 3.11), and on the normalization by Proposition 3.16.

1.2. Classification of jump components. Here we specialize to the case $r = 2$. Let $A = M_B(X, 1)$.

Proposition 1.2 (Proposition 4.3). *Let $Z \subseteq \bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2)$ be an irreducible component. Consider a general point $\rho \in Z$, with $\bar{\rho} : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \text{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ the projective quotient. Then ρ is exactly one of the following cases:*

- (A): ρ is reducible, i.e., $\rho \simeq \chi_1 \oplus \chi_2$;
- (B): ρ is irreducible and dihedral, i.e. up to conjugation, $G_{\bar{\rho}} \subseteq D_\infty$;
- (C): $G_{\bar{\rho}} \simeq \bar{\rho}(\pi_1(X, x)) \simeq A_4, S_4$ or A_5 ;
- (D): $\bar{\rho}$ has Zariski dense image and is rigid;
- (E): $\bar{\rho}$ has Zariski dense image and is non-rigid.

For obvious reason, we call the first 4 cases the virtually abelian jump components, and the last one the nonabelian component. Next, we have a structure theorem for the virtually abelian components:

Theorem 1.3.

- (A): (Proposition 4.5) either $Z \simeq \text{Sym}^2(N)$ or $Z^\nu \simeq N_1 \times N_2$ with $N, N_1, N_2 \subseteq A$ translated subtori of A ;

- (B): ([Proposition 4.7](#)) either $Z^\nu \simeq N$ or $Z \simeq N/\langle \tau^* \rangle$ with N a translated subtorus of A and τ^* an involution on N ;
 (C): ([Proposition 4.9](#)) Z^ν is an algebraic torus;
 (D): ([Proposition 4.10](#)) Z^ν is an algebraic torus.

For a nonabelian jump component, up to taking a finite cover, we can consider a point of Z as a pair $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})$ where $\mathbb{V}$ has fixed determinant and $\mathbb{L}$ is a rank one local system. More precisely, there is a torsion lift $\epsilon \in A$ of some $\bar{\epsilon} \in A/A^2$ such that $Z \subseteq M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2)$. Consider the diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \times A & \xrightarrow[\Phi_\epsilon]{(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}) \mapsto \mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{L}} & M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2) \\ \text{pr}_2 \downarrow & & \downarrow \det \\ A & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{L} \mapsto \epsilon \otimes \mathbb{L}^{\otimes 2}} & A \end{array}$$

and let C be an irreducible component of $\Phi_\epsilon^{-1}(Z)$. We can recover Z , in a sense, as follows (for more details, see [Section 2.5](#))

Proposition 1.4 ([Proposition 2.19](#)). $Z^\nu \simeq C^\nu/H_C$ is an étale quotient of C^ν .

Next we denote the projections:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} C \subseteq \Phi_\epsilon^{-1}(Z) \subseteq M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \times A & & \\ \text{pr}_1 \downarrow & \searrow \text{pr}_2 & \\ M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) & & A \end{array}$$

with images:

$$D = \overline{\text{pr}_1(C)}_{\text{red}} \subseteq M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon), \quad T = \overline{\text{pr}_2(C)}_{\text{red}} \subseteq A$$

Proposition 1.5 ([Corollary 3.12](#)). T is a torsion-translated subtorus of A .

As a consequence of [\[CS08\]](#) we have a factorization of D through a DM-curve:

Proposition 1.6 ([Proposition 5.8](#)). There is a proper hyperbolic DM curve $\mathcal{Y} = [Y/G]$ and a morphism $s : X \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ and an irreducible component Q of a fixed-determinant, fixed-inertia locus $M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 2, \det = \delta, \tau)$ such that

- (1) $s_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$ is a surjection.
- (2) with the closed embedding $s^* : M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 2) \hookrightarrow M_B(X, 2)$, $D \subseteq s^*(Q)$.

Via the closed embedding, we can view C as a subvariety of $Q \times T \subseteq M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 2) \times A$. More precisely,

$$C \subseteq \{(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L}) \in Q \times T \mid \dim H^i(X, s^*\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{L}) \geq k\}$$

On the other hand,

$$R\Gamma(X, s^*\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{L}) \simeq R\Gamma(\mathcal{Y}, \mathbb{W} \otimes R s_* \mathbb{L})$$

hence we can, instead, study a twisted jump loci on the DM-curve $\mathcal{Y}$. For a fixed $\mathbb{L}$, we understand when this cohomology jumps.

Proposition 1.7 (Proposition 5.18). *Either $C = Q \times T$, $C = \{\mathbb{V}\} \times T$, or $\text{pr}_2 : C \rightarrow T$ is generically finite.*

For the case where $\text{pr}_2 : C \rightarrow T$ is generically finite, using an invariant Grassmannian construction, we construct a finite scheme over T (Proposition 5.22) which contains a Zariski open subset of C . As a consequence,

Proposition 1.8 (Proposition 5.23). *If $\text{pr}_2 : C \rightarrow T$ is generically finite, then it is finite and surjective.*

Finally, suppose that $\text{pr}_2 : C \rightarrow T$ is finite, and consider the normalized map $\text{pr}_2^\nu : C^\nu \rightarrow T$. If this is not étale, we can produce a unitary $\mathbb{L} \in T$ with $c \in (\text{pr}_2^\nu)^{-1}(\mathbb{L})$ such that C^ν is smooth at c , pr_2^ν is ramified at c , and

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T, \mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu, c}$$

is an injective morphism of pro-MHS-algebras. This results in a contradiction (Proposition 5.26). Putting everything together we get

Theorem 1.9. *Either $C = Q \times T$, $C = \{\mathbb{V}\} \times T$, or $\text{pr}_2^\nu : C^\nu \rightarrow T$ is étale.*

Corollary 1.10. *If the general point of Z is of type (E), then either Z is an algebraic torus, Z^ν is an algebraic torus, or Z^ν is an étale quotient of $Q^\nu \times T$.*

2. PRELIMINARIES

We work with schemes over $\mathbb{C}$. For a scheme S , let S_{red} be the reduced scheme, and S^ν be the normalization of S .

2.1. Jump ideals. Let A be a noetherian ring, and $K^\bullet$ a bounded above complex of A -modules such that $H^i(K^\bullet)$ is a finitely generated A -module for all i . By [Har77, Lemma III.12.3], there exists a quasi-isomorphism $\phi : L^\bullet \rightarrow K^\bullet$ where $(L^\bullet, d^\bullet)$ is a bounded above complex of finitely generated free A -modules.

Definition 2.1. The cohomological jump ideals of $K^\bullet$ are defined to be

$$J_k^i(K^\bullet) := I_{\text{rank}_A(L^i) - k + 1}(d^{i-1} \oplus d^i) \subset A$$

where I denotes the determinantal ideal generated by $(\text{rank}_A(L^i) - k + 1)^2$ -minors. This definition does not depend on the choice of $L^\bullet$ [BW15, Definition-Proposition 2.2]. We also have that, for a base change $A \rightarrow B$,

$$J_k^i(K^\bullet)B = J_k^i(K^\bullet \otimes_A^L B) \quad (2.1)$$

$$V(J_k^i(K^\bullet)) = \{s \in \text{Spec } A \mid \dim_{\kappa(s)} H^i(K^\bullet \otimes_A^L \kappa(s)) \geq k\} \quad (2.2)$$

Let $S = \text{Spec } A \rightarrow R_B(X, x, r) = \text{Hom}(\pi_1(X, x), \text{GL}_r)$ be a classifying map. This is equivalent to a representation

$$\rho_S : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \text{GL}_r(A)$$

which we might think of as a $A[\pi_1(X, x)]$ -module V_S . Let the corresponding local system of free A -modules on X be denoted $\mathbb{V}_S$. Here we have an explicit free model for $\text{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}_S)$. Fix a finite CW complex structure for X , we can form the

cellular complex $C_\bullet(\tilde{X}, \mathbb{Z})$ on the universal cover $\tilde{X} \rightarrow X$; this is a complex of free $\mathbb{Z}[\pi_1(X, x)]$ -modules. Then

$$C^\bullet(X, \mathbb{V}_S) := \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}[\pi_1(X, x)]}(C_\bullet(\tilde{X}, \mathbb{Z}), V_S)$$

is a complex of free A -modules. Cellular cohomology with local system coefficients identifies this with $R\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}_S)$. Furthermore, for $f : \text{Spec } B \rightarrow S$, we have that

$$C^\bullet(X, \mathbb{V}_S \otimes_{A_X} B_X) = C^\bullet(X, \mathbb{V}_S) \otimes_A B \quad (2.3)$$

with A_X, B_X being the constant local systems on X . Recall that $R_B(X, x, r)$ is affine, and denote the universal local system, which is a local system of free $\Gamma(R_B(X, x, r), \mathcal{O}_{R_B(X, x, r)})$ -modules on X , to be $\mathbb{V}^{\text{univ}}$ (which is just $\mathbb{V}_S$ for $S = R_B(X, x, r)$). We can then give a scheme structure to

$$\Sigma_k^i(X, r) = \{\mathbb{V} \in R_B(X, x, r) \mid \dim H^i(X, \mathbb{V}) \geq k\}$$

as $\Sigma_k^i(X, r) = V(J_k^i(R\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}^{\text{univ}})))$.

2.2. Variations of complex mixed Hodge and twistor structures.

Definition 2.2. A complex pure Hodge structure ($\mathbb{C}$ -HS) of weight n is a finite-dimensional $\mathbb{C}$ -vector space V with n -opposed decreasing filtrations $F^\bullet, F'^\bullet$, i.e.,

$$\text{gr}_F^p \text{gr}_{F'}^q V = 0 \quad p + q \neq n, \quad V = \bigoplus_{p+q=n} V^{p,q}, \quad V^{p,q} = F^p \cap F'^q$$

Morphisms are filtered morphisms. A polarization of V is a hermitian form h such that $V = \bigoplus_{p+q=n} V^{p,q}$ is h -orthogonal, and $\bigoplus_{p+q=n} (-1)^p h|_{V^{p,q}}$ is positive definite.

Definition 2.3. A complex mixed Hodge structure ($\mathbb{C}$ -MHS) is $(V, W_\bullet, F^\bullet, F'^\bullet)$, with $W_\bullet$ an increasing (weight) filtration, such that for any n , the filtrations induced by $F^\bullet, F'^\bullet$ on $\text{gr}_n^W V$ define a pure Hodge structure of weight n .

Morphisms are those compatible with all three filtrations. A graded polarization is a polarization h_n on $\text{gr}_n^W V$ for each n .

Definition 2.4. A complex pure twistor structure ($\mathbb{C}$ -TS) of weight n is a vector bundle $\mathcal{V} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(n)^{\oplus r}$. A complex mixed twistor structure ($\mathbb{C}$ -MTS) is a pair $(\mathcal{V}, W_\bullet)$ where $\mathcal{V}$ is a vector bundle on $\mathbb{P}^1$, $W_\bullet \mathcal{V}$ is a locally split increasing (weight) filtration by subbundles satisfying

$$\text{gr}_n^W \mathcal{V} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(n)^{\oplus r_n}$$

Morphisms of complex mixed twistor structures are $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}$ -linear morphisms.

The complex mixed Hodge and twistor structures form categories $\text{MHS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ and $\text{MTS}_{\mathbb{C}}$. We have fiber functors ω , with image $\mathbb{C}$ -vector spaces, where $\omega(V, W_\bullet, F^\bullet, F'^\bullet) = V$, and $\omega(\mathcal{V}, W_\bullet) = \mathcal{V}|_{\lambda=1}$. Both are then neutral Tannakian categories.

Definition 2.5. A graded polarized complex variation of mixed Hodge structures ($\mathbb{C}$ -VMHS) on X is $(\mathbb{V}, W_\bullet, F^\bullet, F'^\bullet)$ where

- $\mathbb{V}$ is a complex local system on X and $W_\bullet$ is a flat increasing (weight) filtration;

- $F^\bullet, F'^\bullet$ are locally split decreasing filtrations

$$F^p \subset \mathcal{O}_X \otimes_{\mathbb{C}_X} \mathbb{V}, \quad F'^q \subset \overline{\mathcal{O}}_X \otimes_{\mathbb{C}_X} \mathbb{V}$$

by holomorphic and anti-holomorphic subbundles respectively;

- for the natural flat connections $\nabla, \overline{\nabla}$ coming from the exterior derivative, these must satisfy Griffiths transversality

$$\nabla F^p \subset F^{p-1} \otimes \Omega_X^1, \quad \overline{\nabla} F'^q \subset F'^{q-1} \otimes \Omega_X^1$$

- there exists a flat hermitian form h_n on each $\text{gr}_n^W \mathbb{V}$ such that for each $x \in X$, the restriction of the tuple to x gives a graded polarized complex mixed hodge structure.

For the twistor analogue, we first review the theory of harmonic bundle developed by Corlette and Simpson in [Cor88; Sim92].

Definition 2.6. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be a complex C^∞ -vector bundle on a projective complex manifold X equipped with a flat C^∞ -connection D . For h a hermitian metric on $\mathcal{E}$, we have a decomposition

$$D = D_h + \Psi$$

where D_h is unitary with respect to h , and Ψ is self-adjoint for h . Take a further type decomposition into $(1, 0)$ and $(0, 1)$ components

$$D_h = \partial_h + \bar{\partial}_h, \quad \Psi = \theta + \theta^*$$

We say that h is pluriharmonic if $(\theta + \bar{\partial}_h)^2 = 0$. A harmonic bundle $(\mathcal{E}, D, h)$, equivalently $(\mathcal{E}, \bar{\partial}_h, \theta, h)$, is then a smooth complex vector bundle $\mathcal{E}$ with a flat smooth connection D and a pluriharmonic metric h .

Let $\mathcal{A}_X := \mathcal{C}_X^\infty \boxtimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}$ be the sheaf of C^∞ -functions on $X_{\mathbb{P}^1} := X \times \mathbb{P}^1$ which are holomorphic in the $\mathbb{P}^1$ -direction, and choose generating sections $x_0, x_\infty \in H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(1))$ vanishing at 0 and ∞ respectively. Then we get a derivative

$$x_0 \partial_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1} + x_\infty \bar{\partial}_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1} : \mathcal{A}_X \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_X \otimes \Omega_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1}^1(1)$$

with $\Omega_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1}^1(1) := \Omega_X^1 \boxtimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(1)$, where Ω_X^1 is the sheaf of C^∞ -one-forms on X . Let $(\mathcal{E}, \bar{\partial}_h, \theta, h)$ be a harmonic bundle on X , and define $\mathcal{E}_{\mathbb{P}^1} := \mathcal{E} \boxtimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}$. Then we have a $x_0 \partial_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1} + x_\infty \bar{\partial}_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1}$ -connection

$$\mathcal{D} := x_0(\partial_h + \theta^*) + x_\infty(\theta + \bar{\partial}_h) : \mathcal{E}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \otimes \Omega_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1}^1(1), \quad \mathcal{D}^2 = 0$$

where we abuse notation so that $\partial_h + \theta^*, \theta + \bar{\partial}_h$ really mean their natural extensions to $\mathcal{E}_{\mathbb{P}^1}$.

Definition 2.7. The resulting $(\mathcal{E}_{\mathbb{P}^1}, \mathcal{D})$ is the variation of pure twistor structures ($\mathbb{C}$ -VTS) of weight 0 associated to the harmonic bundle $(\mathcal{E}, \bar{\partial}_h, \theta, h)$. We get the weight k $\mathbb{C}$ -VTS associated to $(\mathcal{E}, \bar{\partial}_h, \theta, h)$ by twisting $\mathcal{E}_{\mathbb{P}^1, k} := \mathcal{E} \boxtimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(k)$.

Remark 2.8. Every semisimple complex local system on X underlies a harmonic bundle, hence a variation of pure twistor structures.

Definition 2.9. A graded-polarized variation of mixed twistor structures ($\mathbb{C}$ -VMTS) on X is a triple $(\mathcal{V}, W_\bullet, \mathcal{D})$ such that

- $\mathcal{V}$ is an $\mathcal{A}_X$ -module on $X_{\mathbb{P}^1}$;
- $\mathcal{D} : \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{V} \otimes \Omega_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1}^1(1)$ is a $x_0\partial_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1} + x_\infty\bar{\partial}_{X_{\mathbb{P}^1}/\mathbb{P}^1}$ -connection with $\mathcal{D}^2 = 0$;
- $W_\bullet\mathcal{V}$ is a $\mathcal{D}$ -flat increasing weight filtration of $\mathcal{E}_{\mathbb{P}^1}$;
- each $(\mathrm{gr}_k^W\mathcal{V}, \mathrm{gr}_k^W\mathcal{D})$ has a pluriharmonic hermitian metric h_k making it a $\mathbb{C}$ -VTS of weight k associated to a harmonic bundle.

Morphisms are $\mathcal{A}_X$ -linear morphisms which preserve $W_\bullet$ and commutes with $\mathcal{D}$.

Remark 2.10. On an affine chart $\mathbb{A}_\lambda^1 = \mathbb{P}^1 - \{\infty\}$, let $D_\lambda = x_\infty^{-1}\mathcal{D}|_{X \times \{\lambda\}}$. The data of a $\mathbb{C}$ -VMTS is equivalently a family of integrable λ -connections

$$\nabla_\lambda(fs) = \lambda df \otimes s + f\nabla_\lambda(s), \quad \nabla_\lambda^2 = 0$$

where $\nabla_\lambda = D_\lambda^{0,1}$ on the holomorphic vector bundle $(\mathcal{V}|_\lambda, D_\lambda^{0,1})$. The fibers $\lambda = 1$ and $\lambda = 0$ give a flat bundle, hence an underlying local system by Riemann-Hilbert correspondence, and a Higgs bundle respectively.

2.3. Variations with artinian coefficients. Let $\mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ be either $\mathrm{MHS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ or $\mathrm{MTS}_{\mathbb{C}}$, and $\mathbf{T}(0)$ be the tensor unit in $\mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$.

Definition 2.11. A $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra is a commutative unital algebra object $\mathbf{A} \in \mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$, i.e., $\mathbf{A} \in \mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ with morphisms in $\mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$:

$$\mathbf{T}(0) \xrightarrow{u} \mathbf{A}, \quad \mathbf{A} \otimes \mathbf{A} \xrightarrow{\mu} \mathbf{A}$$

satisfying the usual unit, associativity, and commutativity diagrams. Similarly, we can define $\mathbf{A}$ -MS-algebra (and module) from a $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra $\mathbf{A}$.

We say that $\mathbf{A}$ is artinian local if $\omega(\mathbf{A})$ is an artinian local $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra, and the residue map $\mathbf{A} \twoheadrightarrow \mathbf{T}(0)$ is a morphism in $\mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$. Since $\mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ is abelian, $\mathfrak{m}_{\mathbf{A}} := \ker(\mathbf{A} \twoheadrightarrow \mathbf{T}(0))$ is a subobject of $\mathbf{A}$ in $\mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$, and we have a splitting $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{T}(0) \oplus \mathfrak{m}_{\mathbf{A}}$.

Definition 2.12.

- (1) A pro-MS is a pro-object in $\mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$.
- (2) A pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra is a $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -algebra object in the category of pro-MS. Equivalently, it is an inverse system of $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebras.
- (3) A pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra $\mathbf{\Lambda}$ is complete, noetherian, artinian, or local when $\omega(\mathbf{\Lambda})$ is as a $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra.
- (4) An ideal subobject $\mathbf{I}$ of a (pro-) $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra is a (pro-) $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-ideal if it is a sub pro- $\mathbb{C}$ -MS.
- (5) If $\mathbf{\Lambda}$ is a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra, we define a pro- $\mathbf{\Lambda}$ -MS-module to be a pro- $\mathbf{\Lambda}$ -module object in $\mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$.

Let $a_X : X \rightarrow \mathrm{pt}$, and denote $\mathcal{A} = a_X^*\mathbf{A}$ for $\mathbf{A} \in \mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$, i.e., $\mathcal{A}$ is the constant variation with fiber $\omega(\mathbf{A})$.

Definition 2.13. Let $\mathbf{A} \in \mathrm{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ be an artinian local $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra. An $\mathbf{A}$ -variation of mixed structures ($\mathbf{A}$ -VMS) is a complex variation of mixed Hodge/twistor structures $\mathcal{V}$ together with an action morphism

$$\mathcal{A} \otimes \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}$$

which is a morphism of variations of mixed structures and which satisfies unit and associativity diagrams. We also require the underlying local system of $\mathcal{V}$ to be a local system of free $\omega(\mathbf{A})$ -modules.

If $\mathbf{A}$ is a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra with

$$\mathbf{A} = \varprojlim_n \mathbf{A}_n, \quad \mathbf{A}_n = \mathbf{A}/\mathfrak{m}_{\mathbf{A}}^{n+1}$$

where each $\mathbf{A}_n$ is an artinian local $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra with $\mathbf{A}_{n+1} \rightarrow \mathbf{A}_n$ being a morphism in $\mathbf{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$, then a pro- $\mathbf{A}$ -VMS is of the form

$$\mathcal{V} = \varprojlim_n \mathcal{V}_n, \quad \mathcal{V}_n = \mathcal{V}/\mathfrak{m}_{\mathbf{A}}^{n+1}\mathcal{V}$$

where $\mathcal{V}$ has an underlying local system of free $\omega(\mathbf{A})$ -modules. Each $\mathcal{V}_n$ is a $\mathbb{C}$ -VMS for which the maps $\mathcal{V}_{n+1} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_n$ are morphisms of $\mathbb{C}$ -VMS, each $\mathbf{A}/\mathfrak{m}_{\mathbf{A}}^{n+1} \subset \text{End}(\mathcal{V}_n)$ is a sub $\mathbb{C}$ -MS.

Proposition 2.14. *Let X be a smooth projective complex variety. Let $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbf{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ be an artinian local $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -algebra, and $\mathcal{V}$ an $\mathbf{A}$ -VMS with underlying local system $\mathbb{V}$. Then there is a functorial*

$$K_{\mathbf{A}}(\mathcal{V}) = \text{Ra}_{X,*}^{\text{MS}} \mathcal{V} \in D^b(\mathbf{A}\text{-MS-mod})$$

such that $\omega(K_{\mathbf{A}}(\mathcal{V})) \simeq \text{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V})$ in $D^b(\omega(\mathbf{A})\text{-mod})$. Furthermore, for every morphism $\mathbf{A} \rightarrow \mathbf{B}$ in $\mathbf{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ with the corresponding $\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ of constant variations on X , we have base change

$$K_{\mathbf{A}}(\mathcal{V}) \otimes_{\mathbf{A}}^{\mathbf{L}} \mathbf{B} \simeq K_{\mathbf{B}}(\mathcal{V} \otimes_{\mathcal{A}} \mathcal{B})$$

Proof. Forget about the coefficient $\mathbf{A}$, we can regard $\mathcal{V}$ as a smooth object in the derived category of algebraic complex mixed modules. Then the fact that we have $K(\mathcal{V}) = \text{Ra}_{X,*}^{\text{MS}} \mathcal{V} \in D^b(\mathbf{MS}_{\mathbb{C}})$ with $\omega(K(\mathcal{V})) \simeq \text{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V})$ follows from the six functor formalism. In the Hodge setting, this follows from work of Saito [Sai90, Theorem 0.1]; in the twistor setting, this follows from works of Sabbah and Mochizuki [Sab05; Moc15]. We now show compatibility with the $\mathbf{A}$ -structure. Apply the projection formula, which in this specific case is a consequence of six functor formalism and dualizability of $\mathbf{A}$, to the action morphism $(a_X)^* \mathbf{A} \otimes \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}$ we get

$$\mathbf{A} \otimes \text{Ra}_{X,*}^{\text{MS}} \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \text{Ra}_{X,*}^{\text{MS}} \mathcal{V}$$

and similarly for the unit and associativity diagrams. Regarding the base change $\mathbf{A} \rightarrow \mathbf{B}$, notice that we have a base change morphism by adjunction

$$\mathbf{B} \otimes_{\mathbf{A}}^{\mathbf{L}} \text{Ra}_{X,*}^{\text{MS}} \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \text{Ra}_{X,*}^{\text{MS}} (\mathcal{V} \otimes_{\mathcal{A}} \mathcal{B})$$

which, after applying ω , becomes the base change morphism $\text{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}) \otimes_{\omega(\mathbf{A})}^{\mathbf{L}} \omega(\mathbf{B}) \rightarrow \text{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathcal{A}_X} \mathcal{B}_X)$. This follows from the compatibility of ω with the six functors. The base change $\text{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}) \otimes_{\omega(\mathbf{A})}^{\mathbf{L}} \omega(\mathbf{B}) \rightarrow \text{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V} \otimes_{\mathcal{A}_X} \mathcal{B}_X)$ is an isomorphism due to identifications with free cellular complexes, see (2.3). Finally, ω is faithful and exact, hence its derived version is conservative, and $\mathbf{B} \otimes_{\mathbf{A}}^{\mathbf{L}} \text{Ra}_{X,*}^{\text{MS}} \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \text{Ra}_{X,*}^{\text{MS}} (\mathcal{V} \otimes_{\mathcal{A}} \mathcal{B})$ must be an isomorphism to begin with. $\square$

2.4. Absolute subset and rank one theory. We have a quasi-projective moduli space $R_{\text{DR}}(X, x, r)$ of framed flat connections on X [Sim94, Theorem 6.13]. The Riemann-Hilbert correspondence then induces a complex analytic isomorphism [Sim94, Theorem 7.1]:

$$\text{RH} : R_{\text{DR}}(X, x, r) \xrightarrow{\sim} R_B(X, x, r) \quad (2.4)$$

Given $(E, \nabla) \in R_{\text{DR}}(X, x, r)$ and $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(\mathbb{C}/\mathbb{Q})$, we have a base change $X^\sigma \rightarrow X$ and pulling back gives $(E^\sigma, \nabla^\sigma) \in R_{\text{DR}}(X^\sigma, x, r)$. In fact, this gives a bijection $\sigma : R_{\text{DR}}(X, x, r) \xrightarrow{\sim} R_{\text{DR}}(X^\sigma, x, r)$.

Definition 2.15. A GL_r -invariant subset $\Sigma \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$ is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -constructible if for any $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(\mathbb{C}/\mathbb{Q})$,

$$\Sigma^\sigma := \text{RH} \circ \sigma \circ \text{RH}^{-1}(\Sigma) \subseteq R_B(X^\sigma, x, r)$$

is $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -constructible, i.e., a finite union of locally closed subvarieties defined over $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$.

We have similar notions for the stacks $\mathcal{M}_{B/\text{DR}}(X, r)$ as well as the good moduli spaces $M_{B/\text{DR}}(X, r)$. Now, consider the rank one character variety

$$M_B(X, 1) = \text{Hom}(\pi_1(X, x), \mathbb{C}^*) \simeq (\mathbb{C}^*)^{\text{rank } H_1(X, \mathbb{Z})} \times \text{Hom}(H_1(X, \mathbb{Z})_{\text{tors}}, \mathbb{C}^*) \quad (2.5)$$

which is a finite disjoint union of algebraic tori.

Theorem 2.16 ([BW20; Sim93]). *Every irreducible absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed subset $\Sigma \subseteq M_B(X, 1)$ is a torsion-translated algebraic subtorus*

$$\Sigma = \tau \cdot N$$

where $N \subseteq M_B(X, 1)$ is a subtorus, and $\text{Lie}(N) \subseteq H^1(X, \mathbb{C})$ is a complex Hodge substructure. Absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -constructible subsets are obtained from a finite sequence of unions, intersections and complements.

Proof. The first and last statement follows from [Sim93, Theorem 6.1] and [BW20, Theorem 9.1.2]. Regarding the Lie algebra, by [Sim93, Theorem 6.1], N is a triple torus, hence by [Sim93, Theorem 2.1] there exists abelian subvariety $P \subseteq \text{Alb}(X)$ such that N is the image of $M_B(\text{Alb}(X)/P, 1) \hookrightarrow M_B(X, 1)$. The map on tangent space is

$$H^1(\text{Alb}(X)/P, \mathbb{C}) \hookrightarrow H^1(X, \mathbb{C})$$

is induced by $\pi^* : H^1(\text{Alb}(X)/P, \mathbb{C}) \rightarrow H^1(\text{Alb}(X), \mathbb{C}) \simeq H^1(X, \mathbb{C})$ where $\pi : \text{Alb}(X) \rightarrow \text{Alb}(X)/P$ is the projection. Pullback is a Hodge morphism hence we are done. $\square$

Corollary 2.17 ([BW20, Theorem 11.1.1]). *Let $\mathcal{F} \in D_c^b(X, \mathbb{C})$ be of geometric origin, then the twisted jump loci*

$$\Sigma_k^i(X, \mathcal{F}) = \{ \mathbb{V} \in R_B(X, 1) \mid \dim \mathbb{H}^i(X, \mathcal{F} \otimes \mathbb{V}) \geq k \}$$

is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed and thus a finite union of torsion-translated algebraic subtori. If $\mathcal{F}$ is not of geometric origin, then $\Sigma_k^i(X, \mathcal{F})$ is only a finite union of translated algebraic subtori.

2.5. Determinant sheet. In this section, let $A = M_B(X, 1)$ and the decomposition (2.5) be $A = A^\circ \times \hat{T}$, where $T = H_1(X, \mathbb{Z})_{\text{tors}}$. Since T is finite, its dual $\hat{T}$ is also finite. We have the squaring map

$$[2] : A \rightarrow A, \quad \mathbb{L} \mapsto \mathbb{L}^{\otimes 2}$$

and let $A^2 = \text{im}[2]$, $A[2] = \ker[2]$. Then $A/A^2 \simeq \hat{T}/\hat{T}^2$ is a finite group. For each $\bar{\epsilon} \in A/A^2$ we can pick a torsion lift $\epsilon \in A$. Let ϵA^2 be the coset $\epsilon A^2 = \{\epsilon \otimes \mathbb{L}^{\otimes 2} \mid \mathbb{L} \in A\}$, then

$$A = \bigsqcup_{\bar{\epsilon} \in A/A^2} \epsilon A^2$$

and thus

$$M_B(X, 2) = \bigsqcup_{\bar{\epsilon} \in A/A^2} M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2)$$

For each $\bar{\epsilon} \in A/A^2$ with torsion lift $\epsilon \in A$, we have the following proposition

Proposition 2.18. *There is a Cartesian diagram*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \times A & \xrightarrow[\Phi_\epsilon]{(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}) \mapsto \mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{L}} & M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2) \\ \text{pr}_2 \downarrow & & \downarrow \det \\ A & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{L} \mapsto \epsilon \otimes \mathbb{L}^{\otimes 2}} & A \end{array} \quad (2.5)$$

and Φ_ϵ is a finite étale $A[2]$ -torsor over $M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2)$, with the action

$$\rho \cdot (\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}) = (\mathbb{V} \otimes \rho, \mathbb{L} \otimes \rho^{-1})$$

The same is true for the quotient stacks and framed moduli schemes.

Proof. Notice that

$$M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2) \times_A A = \{(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L}) \mid \det \mathbb{W} = \epsilon \otimes \mathbb{L}^{\otimes 2}\}$$

which is isomorphic to $M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \times A$ via the maps

$$\begin{aligned} M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2) \times_A A &\rightarrow M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \times A \\ (\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L}) &\mapsto (\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{L}^{-1}, \mathbb{L}) \\ (\mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{L}, \mathbb{L}) &\mapsto (\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}) \end{aligned}$$

Next, the map downstairs is a $A[2]$ -torsor over ϵA^2 , with the action $\rho \cdot \mathbb{L} = \mathbb{L} \otimes \rho^{-1}$. Hence Φ_ϵ is also a $A[2]$ -torsor. The induced action on $M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2) \times_A A$ is $\rho \cdot (\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L}) = (\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L} \otimes \rho^{-1})$ which translate to the stated action on $M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \times A$. $\square$

Now, let $Z \subset M_B(X, 2)$ be an irreducible subvariety, then it must be contained in some $M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2)$. We can then look at $\phi_\epsilon^{-1}(Z)$ and pick an irreducible component C . Set $H_C = \{\rho \in A[2] \mid \rho \cdot C = C\}$.

Proposition 2.19. *The induces map between normalizations $C^\nu \rightarrow Z^\nu$ is a finite étale H_C -torsor, and $Z^\nu \simeq C^\nu/H_C$.*

Proof. We have a base change diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} W & \xrightarrow{f} & \Phi_\epsilon^{-1}(Z) \\ \downarrow g & & \downarrow \phi_\chi \\ Z^\nu & \xrightarrow{\nu} & Z \end{array}$$

where g is a finite étale $A[2]$ -torsor. Let η_Z be the generic point of Z , then the generic point η_C of C lies over η_Z . Notice that we have an isomorphism of function fields $\kappa(\eta_{Z^\nu}) \simeq \kappa(\eta_Z)$, hence there is an isomorphism of generic fibers $W_{\eta_{Z^\nu}} \simeq \Phi_\epsilon^{-1}(Z)_{\eta_Z}$. Thus there is a $W_{\eta_{Z^\nu}} \ni \eta \mapsto \eta_C$ under this identification. Let $\overline{C}$ be the closure of η in W . Since $W \rightarrow Z^\nu$ is finite étale, $\overline{C}$ is an irreducible component of W . It follows that $\overline{C}$ is open and closed in W , and $\overline{C} \rightarrow Z^\nu$ is a finite étale H_C -torsor.

On the other hand, $W \rightarrow \Phi_\epsilon^{-1}(Z)$ is finite, since it is the base change of ν which is finite. Thus $\overline{C} \rightarrow C$ is finite. It is also birational by construction, hence $\overline{C} = C^\nu$. $\square$

3. HODGE THEORY OF R_B AND M_B

In this section, we prove that the cohomological jump loci enjoy several nice Hodge theoretic properties. We first briefly recall some results and definitions, following the exposition of [BBT24].

3.1. Betti universal deformation algebra and Deligne-Hitchin space.

Theorem 3.1 ([BBT24, Theorem 4.2]). *Let $(\mathbb{V}, \phi)$ be a framed rank r local system underlying a $\mathbb{C}$ -VMS $\mathcal{V}$, then the completed local ring $\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)} := \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{R_B(X, x, r), (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ has a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra structure $\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ with*

$$\omega(\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}) = \Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$$

and the universal formal local system $\widehat{\mathbb{V}}$ underlies a free pro- $\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ -VMS $\widehat{\mathbb{V}}$. The universal framing $\widehat{\phi} : \widehat{\mathbb{V}}_x \rightarrow \Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)} \widehat{\otimes}_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{C}^r$ is the image under ω of a morphism of pro- $\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ -MS-modules $\widehat{\phi} : \widehat{\mathbb{V}}_x \rightarrow \Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)} \widehat{\otimes}_{\mathbf{T}(0)} \mathbf{T}(0)^{\oplus r}$.

These structures are uniquely determined by the following universal property: For any artinian local $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra $\mathbf{A}$ and any $\mathbf{A}$ -VMS $\mathcal{U}$ with a framing $\psi : \mathcal{U}_x \rightarrow \mathbf{A} \otimes_{\mathbf{T}(0)} \mathbf{T}(0)^{\oplus r}$ which restricts to $(\mathcal{V}, \phi) \bmod \mathfrak{m}_{\mathbf{A}}$, there is a unique morphism $\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)} \rightarrow \mathbf{A}$ of local pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebras such that

$$(\mathbf{A}, (\mathcal{U}, \psi)) \simeq \mathbf{A} \widehat{\otimes}_{\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}} \left(\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}, (\widehat{\mathbb{V}}, \widehat{\phi}) \right)$$

or, in other words, $\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ represents the functor

$$\mathbf{A} \mapsto \{\text{framed free } \mathbf{A}\text{-VMS deformations of } (\mathcal{V}, \phi)\} / \simeq$$

For a $\mathbb{C}$ -scheme T , denote $X_T = X \times T$ with projection $\pi_T : X_T \rightarrow T$.

Proposition 3.2 ([Sim96, Proposition 4.1]). *The moduli functor*

$$R_{\text{Hod}}(r)(T) = \left\{ (\lambda, E_T, \nabla_{\lambda, T}, \phi) \left| \begin{array}{l} E_T \text{ locally free of rank } r \text{ on } X_T, \\ \lambda \in \Gamma(T, \mathcal{O}_T), \\ \pi_T^{-1} \mathcal{O}_T - \text{linear } \nabla_{\lambda, T} : E_T \rightarrow E_T \otimes \Omega_{X_T/T}^1, \\ \nabla_{\lambda, T}^2 = 0, \\ \nabla_{\lambda, T}(fs) = \lambda d_{X_T/T} f \otimes s + f \nabla_{\lambda, T} s \\ \phi : E_T|_{x \times T} \simeq \mathcal{O}_T^r \end{array} \right. \right\} / \simeq$$

is representable by a relative scheme $R_{\text{Hod}}(X, x, r) \xrightarrow{\lambda} \mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1$ parametrizing λ -connections with a framing. Furthermore, there is a $\mathbb{G}_m$ -action on $R_{\text{Hod}}(X, x, r)$, covering the scaling action on $\mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1$, by scaling the λ -connection.

Definition 3.3. Consider the complex conjugate variety X^c , we can similarly define $R_{\text{Hod}}(X^c, x, r)$ and there is a holomorphic isomorphism

$$R_{\text{Hod}}(X, x, r)|_{\mathbb{G}_m} \simeq R_{\text{Hod}}(X^c, x, r)|_{\mathbb{G}_m} \quad (3.1)$$

and there is a gluing to get the *Deligne-Hitchin* scheme $R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r) \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$. We have the derivations associated to the $\mathbb{G}_m$ -actions on $R_{\text{Hod}}(X, x, r)$ and $R_{\text{Hod}}(X^c, x, r)$ which glue to a derivation Θ on $R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r)$.

Proposition 3.4 ([BBT24, Corollary 8.8]). *Let $\mathbf{A}$ be an artinian local $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra. An $\mathbf{A}$ -VMTS $\mathcal{V}$ is equivalent to a $\mathbb{P}^1$ -morphism $\text{Spec}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathbf{A} \rightarrow R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r)$.*

Definition 3.5. If $\mathcal{V}$ is a $\mathbb{C}$ -VTS on X , then the resulting $\mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r)$ is called a preferred section.

More concretely, if $(\mathbb{V}, \phi) \in R_B(X, x, r)$ is a semisimple framed local system, then it underlies a canonical weight 0 $\mathbb{C}$ -VTS, giving a preferred section

$$s_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)} : \mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r) \quad (3.2)$$

where $s_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}(1)$ is the flat bundle corresponding to $(\mathbb{V}, \phi)$ via the Riemann-Hilbert correspondence.

Proposition 3.6 ([BBT24, Lemma 8.11]). *We have a classifying map for the universal $\text{pro-}\mathbf{A}_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ -VMS $\widehat{\mathcal{V}}$,*

$$\widehat{s}_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)} : \text{Spf}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathbf{A}_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)} \xrightarrow{\simeq} \widehat{R}_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r)_{s_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}} \quad (3.3)$$

which is an isomorphism onto the completion of $R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r)$ along the preferred section.

3.2. Jump loci are Hodge subvarieties. Let $\mathcal{M}_B(X, r)$ be the quotient stack of local systems of rank r , and $\mathcal{Z} \subseteq \mathcal{M}_B(X, r)$ locally closed substack. Let $\mathbb{V} \in \mathcal{Z}(\mathbb{C})$ be a semisimple local system, and pick a framing $\phi : \mathbb{V}_x \xrightarrow{\simeq} \mathbb{C}^r$. Denote $R\mathcal{Z} \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$ the base change to the framed space.

Definition 3.7 ([BBT24, Section 8.5]). $\mathcal{Z}$ is *Hodge* at $\mathbb{V}$ if

- (H1): equipping $\mathbb{V}$ with the canonical weight 0 $\mathbb{C}$ -VTS, the quotient $\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)} \twoheadrightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{RZ, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ underlies a quotient map of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MTS-algebras. If $\mathbb{V}$ is a $\mathbb{C}^*$ -fixed point, then we can equip $\mathbb{V}$ with a canonical weight 0, and the quotient $\Lambda_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)} \twoheadrightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{RZ, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ underlies a quotient map of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra. Denote $\mathbf{\Gamma}_{Z, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ the corresponding pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra on $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{RZ, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$.
- (H2): The formal twistor subspace $\mathrm{Spf}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathbf{\Gamma}_{Z, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)} \subseteq \mathrm{Spf}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathbf{\Lambda}_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ is tangent to the derivation Θ in Definition 3.3.
- (H3): We have an induced map by composition

$$\hat{s}_{RZ, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)} : \mathrm{Spf}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathbf{\Gamma}_{Z, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)} \rightarrow \hat{R}_{\mathrm{DH}}(X, x, r)_{s_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}}$$

Denote Z_{Hod} (resp. $Z_{\overline{\mathrm{Hod}}}$) the Zariski closure of the image of $\hat{s}_{RZ, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}|_{\mathbb{A}_\lambda^1}$ (resp. $\hat{s}_{RZ, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}|_{\mathbb{P}^1 \setminus \{0\}}$) in $R_{\mathrm{Hod}}(X, x, r)$ (resp. $R_{\mathrm{Hod}}(X^c, x, r)$). Then $\hat{s}_{RZ, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}|_{\mathbb{G}_m}$ induces an isomorphism onto the completion of $Z_{\mathrm{Hod}}|_{\mathbb{G}_m}$ along the image of $s_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$, and the same is true for $\hat{s}_{RZ, (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}|_{\mathbb{G}_m}$ and $Z_{\overline{\mathrm{Hod}}}|_{\mathbb{G}_m}$.

$\mathcal{Z}$ is a *Hodge substack* if it is closed under semisimplification and Hodge at every semisimple $\mathbb{V} \in \mathcal{Z}(\mathbb{C})$. Notice that these conditions rely only on $R\mathcal{Z} \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$, so we have a similar notion of *Hodge subvariety* for a GL_r -invariant subvariety $Z \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$. We also have obvious generalization to Hodge subvarieties of products of character varieties.

Lemma 3.8. *Let $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbf{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ be an artinian local $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra, with $A = \omega(\mathbf{A})$, and $\mathbf{K} \in D^b(\mathbf{A}\text{-MS-mod})$ with $K = \omega(\mathbf{K})$ quasi-isomorphic to a bounded above complex of free A -modules. Then $J_k^i(K) \subseteq A$ is the image under ω of an ideal subobject $J_k^i(\mathbf{K}) \subseteq \mathbf{A}$. This construction commutes with $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra coefficient base change.*

Proof. Let $G = \mathrm{Aut}^\otimes(\omega)$ be the Tannakian dual of $\mathbf{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$. Then we have an equivalence of category $\mathbf{MS}_{\mathbb{C}} \simeq \mathrm{Rep}_{\mathbb{C}}^{\mathrm{fd}}(G)$. Under this equivalence, $\mathbf{A}$ is identified with $A = \omega(\mathbf{A})$ with an algebraic G -action, i.e., a comodule structure $\delta_A : A \rightarrow A \otimes \mathcal{O}(G)$; this is an action by algebra automorphism. Similarly, $\mathbf{K}$ gives a G -equivariant complex $K = \omega(\mathbf{K})$ of A -modules.

Let B be a $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra, and $g \in G(B)$, all the tensor product below will be over $\mathbb{C}$ unless specified otherwise. We have a B -algebra automorphism $g : A \otimes B \rightarrow A \otimes B$. Since B is flat over $\mathbb{C}$, the action of g on $K \otimes^L B = K \otimes B$ satisfies

$$g \cdot (bm) = g(b)(g \cdot m) \quad b \in A \otimes B, m \in K^i \otimes B$$

coming from applying ω to the action morphism $\mathbf{A} \otimes \mathbf{K} \rightarrow \mathbf{K}$. It follows that

$$g^*(K \otimes B) := (A \otimes B) \otimes_g (K \otimes B) \simeq K \otimes B$$

since $g : A \otimes B \rightarrow A \otimes B$ is an isomorphism. Determinantal ideals commute with arbitrary base change, and by (2.1) we get

$$g(J_k^i(K \otimes B)) = J_k^i(g^*(K \otimes B)) \simeq J_k^i(K \otimes B)$$

thus $J_k^i(K \otimes B)$ is stable under the action of $g \in G(B)$. It follows that $J_k^i(K)$ is a G -subrepresentation. The equivalence then gives a unique subobject $J_k^i(\mathbf{K}) \subseteq \mathbf{A}$ in

$\mathbf{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ with $\omega(J_k^i(\mathbf{K})) = J_k^i(K)$. To check that $J_k^i(\mathbf{K})$ is an ideal subobject, it suffices to check that the composition

$$\mathbf{A} \otimes J_k^i(\mathbf{K}) \rightarrow \mathbf{A} \otimes \mathbf{A} \xrightarrow{\mu} \mathbf{A}$$

factors through $J_k^i(\mathbf{K}) \subseteq \mathbf{A}$. Equivalently,

$$\mathbf{A} \otimes J_k^i(\mathbf{K}) \rightarrow \mathbf{A} \rightarrow \mathbf{A}/J_k^i(\mathbf{K})$$

is zero. This follows from ω being faithful and the image of that map under ω is zero. Compatibility with coefficient base change follows from (2.1). $\square$

The jump loci $\Sigma_k^i(X, r) \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$ is invariant under the conjugation action by GL_r , so we can ask whether it is a Hodge subvariety.

Theorem 3.9. *For smooth projective X , the jump locus $\Sigma_k^i(X, r) \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$ is a Hodge subvariety. Furthermore, it is closed under semisimplification, and $\Sigma_k^i(X, r)_{\mathrm{red}}$ is a Hodge subvariety which is absolute $\mathbb{Q}$ -closed.*

Every irreducible component of $\Sigma_k^i(X, r)_{\mathrm{red}}$ is a Hodge subvariety and is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed.

Proof. We first verify that $\Sigma_k^i(X, r)$ satisfies the three conditions in Definition 3.7.

(H1). Consider $(\mathbb{V}, \phi) \in R_B(X, x, r)$ semisimple, and let

$$\Lambda = \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{R_B(X, x, r), (\mathbb{V}, \phi)}, \quad \Lambda_n = \Lambda/\mathfrak{m}_{\Lambda}^{n+1}$$

Equip $\mathbb{V}$ with the canonical weight 0 $\mathbb{C}$ -VTS. If $\mathbb{V}$ is a $\mathbb{C}^*$ -fixed point, then it underlies a canonical weight 0 $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS. By Theorem 3.1, Λ underlies a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra $\mathbf{A}$, and the universal formal local system $(\hat{\mathbb{V}}, \hat{\phi})$ underlies a pro- $\mathbf{A}$ -VMS $(\hat{\mathcal{V}}, \hat{\phi})$. Each Λ_n underlies a $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-algebra $\Lambda_n = \mathbf{A}/\mathfrak{m}_{\Lambda}^{n+1}$. Write $\mathcal{V}_n = \hat{\mathcal{V}} \hat{\otimes}_{\Lambda} \Lambda_n$, and $\mathbb{V}_n$ the underlying local system of $\mathcal{V}_n$. By Proposition 2.14 we have

$$\mathbf{K}_n = \mathrm{Ra}_{X,*}^{\mathrm{MS}} \mathcal{V}_n \in D^b(\Lambda_n\text{-MS-mod}), \quad \omega(\mathbf{K}_n) \simeq \mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}_n)$$

Let $R = \Gamma(R_B(X, x, r), \mathcal{O}_{R_B(X, x, r)})$, then $R_B(X, x, r) = \mathrm{Spec} R$. By the discussion of universal cellular complex in Section 2.1, we get a complex $C^\bullet(X, \mathbb{V}^{\mathrm{univ}}) \simeq \mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}^{\mathrm{univ}})$ of free R -modules which we can think of as a complex of free sheaves on $R_B(X, x, r)$. Its fiber over a point $(\mathbb{W}, \psi) \in R_B(X, x, r)$ gives $\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{W})$. Notice that in Λ , the jump ideal becomes

$$J_k^i(\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}^{\mathrm{univ}})) \cdot \Lambda = \varprojlim J_k^i(\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}^{\mathrm{univ}})) \cdot \Lambda_n$$

Recall that we have base change

$$\begin{aligned} J_k^i(\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}^{\mathrm{univ}})) \cdot \Lambda_n &\simeq J_k^i(\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}^{\mathrm{univ}}) \otimes_R^L \Lambda_n) \\ &\simeq J_k^i(\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}^{\mathrm{univ}} \otimes_R^L \Lambda_n)) \\ &\simeq J_k^i(\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}_n)) \end{aligned}$$

thus $J_k^i(\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \mathbb{V}^{\mathrm{univ}})) \cdot \Lambda \simeq J_k^i(\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \hat{\mathbb{V}}))$. Now, $\omega(\mathbf{K}_n)$ is quasi-isomorphic to a complex of free Λ_n -modules, which is $C^\bullet(X, \mathbb{V}_n)$, hence by Lemma 3.8 we get that $J_k^i(\mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, \hat{\mathbb{V}}))$ underlies a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MS-ideal $J_k^i(\mathbf{K}) \subseteq \mathbf{A}$. It follows that we get (H1) since $\mathbf{MS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ is abelian.

(H3). We first take a detour. Let $\mathbf{A} \in \text{MTS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ with $A = \omega(\mathbf{A})$, and $\mathcal{W}$ an $\mathbf{A}$ -VMTS with underlying local system $\mathbb{W}$ of free A -modules. By Remark 2.10, this is the same as a family of holomorphic integrable λ -connections. Let $X_{\lambda} = X \times \mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1$ with projection $\pi : X_{\lambda} \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1$, then the family of λ -connections, over the patch $\mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1$, is the same as a holomorphic bundle $\mathcal{W}_{\lambda}$ on X_{λ} with an integrable $\nabla_{\lambda} : \mathcal{W}_{\lambda} \rightarrow \mathcal{W}_{\lambda} \otimes \Omega_{X_{\lambda}/\mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1}^1$. The $\mathbf{A}$ -action becomes an $A[\lambda]$ -action. We can then form the λ -De Rham complex

$$\text{DR}_{\lambda}(\mathcal{W}_{\lambda}) = \left[\mathcal{W}_{\lambda} \xrightarrow{\nabla_{\lambda}} \mathcal{W}_{\lambda} \otimes \Omega_{X_{\lambda}/\mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1}^1 \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow \mathcal{W}_{\lambda} \otimes \Omega_{X_{\lambda}/\mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1}^{\dim X} \right]$$

and $(\text{Ra}_{X,*}^{\text{MS}} \mathcal{W})|_{\mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1} \simeq \text{R}\pi_* \text{DR}_{\lambda}(\mathcal{W}_{\lambda}) \in D^b(A[\lambda]\text{-mod})$, by [Sim97, proof of Theorem 4.1] and the proof of Proposition 2.14. Denote

$$K_{\text{Hod}}(\mathcal{W}) := \text{R}\pi_* \text{DR}_{\lambda}(\mathcal{W}_{\lambda})$$

Next, let $q : R_{\text{Hod}}(X, x, r) \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1$ be the Hodge moduli space. This carries a universal λ -connection $(\mathcal{V}_{\lambda}^{\text{univ}}, \nabla_{\lambda})$ on $X \times R_{\text{Hod}}$. If the classifying Deligne-Hitchin section for $\mathcal{W}$ is $s_{\mathcal{W}} : \text{Spec}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathbf{A} \rightarrow R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r)$, denote $s_{\mathcal{W},\lambda} := s_{\mathcal{W}}|_{\mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1} : \text{Spec } A[\lambda] \rightarrow R_{\text{Hod}}(X, x, r)$, and

$$(\mathcal{W}_{\lambda}, \nabla_{\lambda}) = s_{\mathcal{W},\lambda}^*(\mathcal{V}_{\lambda}^{\text{univ}}, \nabla_{\lambda})$$

The complex K_{Hod} satisfies base change (same proof as in [Sta26, Tag 0FM0] works), hence

$$K_{\text{Hod}}(\mathcal{W}) \simeq s_{\mathcal{W},\lambda}^* K_{\text{Hod}}(\mathcal{V}^{\text{univ}})$$

where $K_{\text{Hod}}(\mathcal{V}^{\text{univ}}) := \text{R}\pi_* \text{DR}_{\lambda}(\mathcal{V}_{\lambda}^{\text{univ}}, \nabla_{\lambda})$. We can think of this as a complex of $A[\lambda]$ -modules, hence a notion of λ -jump ideal makes sense. Denote $\Sigma_{k,\text{Hod}}^i(X, r) = V(J_k^i(K_{\text{Hod}}(\mathcal{V}^{\text{univ}})))$. The restriction to $\lambda = 1$ gives the De Rham complex for the flat bundle corresponding to $\mathbb{W}$ via the Riemann-Hilbert correspondence, hence by the comparison theorem this gives $\Sigma_k^i(\mathbb{W})$.

Back to our situation, let $s_n : \text{Spec}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathbf{\Lambda}_n \rightarrow R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r)$ be the classifying map for the $\mathbf{\Lambda}_n$ -VMTS $\mathcal{V}_n$. The reduction mod $\mathfrak{m}_{\mathbf{\Lambda}}$ gives $s_{(\mathbb{V},\phi)} : \mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r)$, the preferred section associated to the canonical weight 0 $\mathbb{C}$ -VTS on semisimple $\mathbb{V}$. Let $\mathbf{\Gamma} = \mathbf{\Lambda}/J_k^i(\mathbf{K})$ be the pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MTS-algebra on $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{\Sigma_k^i(\mathbb{V},\phi)}$, and put

$$s_{n,\Sigma} : \text{Spec}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathbf{\Gamma}_n \rightarrow \text{Spec}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathbf{\Lambda}_n \xrightarrow{s_n} R_{\text{DH}}(X, x, r)$$

Notice that

$$s_n^* J_k^i(K_{\text{Hod}}(\mathcal{V}^{\text{univ}})) = J_k^i(s_n^* K_{\text{Hod}}(\mathcal{V}^{\text{univ}})) \simeq J_k^i(\mathbf{K}_n|_{\mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1}) \simeq J_k^i(\mathbf{K}_n)|_{\mathbb{A}_{\lambda}^1}$$

thus the image of $s_{n,\Sigma}|_{\mathbb{G}_m}$ agrees with the $(n+1)$ -th order neighborhood of the image of $s_{(\mathbb{V},\phi)}|_{\mathbb{G}_m}$ in $\Sigma_{k,\text{Hod}}^i(X, r)$. It follows that the image of $\hat{s}_{\Sigma}|_{\mathbb{G}_m}$ agrees with the completion of $\Sigma_{k,\text{Hod}}^i(X, r)$ along the image of $s_{(\mathbb{V},\phi)}$, as desired.

(H2). The scaling $\mathbb{G}_m$ -action turns $t \cdot (\mathcal{V}_{\lambda}^{\text{univ}}, \nabla_{\lambda}) \mapsto (\mathcal{V}_{\lambda}^{\text{univ}}, t\nabla_{\lambda})$. Multiplication by t^p in degree p gives a quasi-isomorphism

$$\text{DR}_{\lambda}(\mathcal{V}_{\lambda}^{\text{univ}}, \nabla_{\lambda}) \simeq \text{DR}_{\lambda}(\mathcal{V}_{\lambda}^{\text{univ}}, t\nabla_{\lambda})$$

thus $J_k^i(K_{\text{Hod}}(\mathcal{V}^{\text{univ}}))$ is $\mathbb{G}_m$ -invariant, hence so is $\Sigma_{k,\text{Hod}}^i(X, r)$. It follows that

$$\Theta(J_k^i(K_{\text{Hod}})) \subseteq J_k^i(K_{\text{Hod}})$$

and completing along the image of $s_{(\mathbb{V}, \phi)}$ gives **(H2)** by the identification in the previous section.

Closed under semisimplification and absoluteness. Closure under semisimplification follows from semicontinuity of local system cohomology. Absoluteness follows from the same proof as in [BW20, Theorem 11.1.1]. Finally, irreducible components and reduction remains Hodge, due to [BBT24, Proposition 8.21(3)], and absolute. $\square$

Corollary 3.10. *Using the notation of Section 2.5, let Z be an irreducible component of $\Sigma_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq R_B(X, x, 2)$. Let C be an irreducible component of $\phi_\chi^{-1}(Z) \subset R_B(X, 2, \det = \chi) \times A$, and denote*

$$T := \overline{\text{pr}_2(C)}_{\text{red}}$$

the Zariski closure of the reduced image of the projection onto $A = M_B(X, 1)$. Then T is a torsion-translated subtorus of A .

*Furthermore, if $\mathbb{L} \in T$ is a unitary point, then $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T, \mathbb{L}}$ underlies a pro-**T**(0)-MHS-algebra such that for every $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}) \in C$ underlying $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS, $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T, \mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C, (\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})}$ is a morphism of pro-**T**(0)-MHS-algebras.*

Proof. By [BBT24, Proposition 9.10], all the morphisms in

$$\begin{array}{ccc} R_B(X, 2, \det = \chi) \times A & \xrightarrow[\Phi_\chi]{(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}) \mapsto \mathbb{V} \otimes \mathbb{L}} & R_B(X, 2, \det \in \chi A^2) \\ \text{pr}_2 \downarrow & & \downarrow \det \\ A & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{L} \mapsto \chi \otimes \mathbb{L}^{\otimes 2}} & A \end{array}$$

are absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -morphisms [BBT24, Definition 9.9]. By the previous theorem, Z is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed. Thus $\phi_\chi^{-1}(Z)$ is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed, and $\text{pr}_2(C)$ is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -constructible. By [BBT24, Proposition 9.14], T is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed. Thus by Theorem 2.16, $T = \tau \cdot N$ where N is a subtorus of A , and $\text{Lie}(N)$ is a complex sub Hodge structure of $H^1(X, \mathbb{C})$.

Now, suppose $\mathbb{L} \in T$ is unitary, then $\mathbb{L}$ underlies a canonical weight 0 $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS, and by Theorem 3.1, $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{A, \mathbb{L}}$ underlies a pro-**T**(0)-MHS-algebra. Furthermore, since A and T are smooth, $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T, \mathbb{L}}$ and $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{A, \mathbb{L}}$ are determined by tangent spaces, i.e.,

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{A, \mathbb{L}} \simeq \widehat{\text{Sym}} H^1(X, \mathbb{C})^\vee, \quad \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T, \mathbb{L}} \simeq \widehat{\text{Sym}} \text{Lie}(N)^\vee$$

and $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{A, \mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T, \mathbb{L}}$ is a quotient of pro-**T**(0)-MHS-algebras. Furthermore, $H^1(X, \mathbb{C})$ is pure of weight 1, hence so is $\text{Lie}(N)$ and we get $\mathfrak{m}_{T, \mathbb{L}} = W_{-1} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T, \mathbb{L}}$ with $\mathfrak{m}_{T, \mathbb{L}} / \mathfrak{m}_{T, \mathbb{L}}^2$ is pure of weight -1 . Suppose that $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}) \in C$ is a $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS point, equivalently $\mathbb{V}$ underlies a weight 0 $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS, then

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{R_B(X, 2, \det = \chi), \mathbb{V}} \hat{\otimes} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{A, \mathbb{L}} \twoheadrightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C, (\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})}$$

is a quotient of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras. The composition

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{A,\mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{R_B(X,2,\det=\chi),\mathbb{V}} \hat{\otimes} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{A,\mathbb{L}} \twoheadrightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C,(\mathbb{V},\mathbb{L})}$$

is thus a morphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras. This factors through $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{A,\mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T,\mathbb{L}}$ which is a quotient of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras, hence the factorization

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T,\mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C,(\mathbb{V},\mathbb{L})}$$

is a morphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras, as desired. $\square$

3.3. Hodge structures on good moduli image. For a Hodge subvariety $W \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$, at a point $(\mathbb{V}, \phi) \in W$ with $\mathbb{V}$ underlying a canonical weight 0 complex variation of Hodge structures, we have a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra structure on $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}$. We prove a similar statement for the reduced image of W under the GIT quotient $q : R_B(X, x, r) \rightarrow M_B(X, r) = R_B(X, x, r)/\mathrm{GL}_2$.

Proposition 3.11. *Let $W \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$ be a Hodge subvariety, and $Z = q(W)_{\mathrm{red}} \subset M_B(X, r)$. Let $\mathbb{V} \in Z$ be a $\mathbb{C}^*$ -fixed point, hence underlying a weight 0 complex variation of Hodge structures. Then $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Z,\mathbb{V}}$ underlies a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra, with*

$$\mathfrak{m}_{Z,\mathbb{V}} = W_{-1}\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Z,\mathbb{V}}$$

Proof. The stabilizer of $(\mathbb{V}, \phi) \in R_B(X, x, r)$ under the GL_r -action is $\mathrm{Aut}(\mathbb{V})$. Denote $H_{\mathbb{V}} = \mathrm{Aut}(\mathbb{V}) \subset \mathrm{GL}_r$. We have an isotypic decomposition

$$\mathbb{V} \simeq \bigoplus \mathbb{V}_{\alpha} \otimes M_{\alpha}$$

where $\{\mathbb{V}_{\alpha}\}$ are pairwise non-isomorphic irreducible local systems, and $\{M_{\alpha}\}$ are complex vector spaces. By equipping each $\mathbb{V}_{\alpha}$ with a weight 0 $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS and M_{α} with a pure complex Hodge structure of type $(0, 0)$, we get an equality of $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS. Then by Schur's lemma, $H_{\mathbb{V}} = \prod \mathrm{GL}(M_{\alpha})$, hence acts by weight 0 automorphisms of the $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS on $\mathbb{V}$.

On the other hand, by picking a framing we get $(\mathbb{V}, \phi) \in W$ lying over $\mathbb{V}$. Recall that included in the definition of Hodge subvariety is the fact that W is GL_r -invariant. Since $\mathbb{V}$ is semisimple, the GL_r -orbit of $(\mathbb{V}, \phi)$ is closed. Then by the Luna étale slice theorem (see [Lun73] or [AHR20, Remark 4.6]) there exists a $H_{\mathbb{V}}$ -invariant affine subscheme $Y \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$ containing $(\mathbb{V}, \phi)$ such that $\mathrm{GL}_r \times^{H_{\mathbb{V}}} Y \rightarrow R_B(X, x, r)$ is étale; its image $U \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$ is a GL_r -invariant saturated (i.e., $U = q^{-1} \circ q(U)$) affine open. Here

$$\mathrm{GL}_r \times^{H_{\mathbb{V}}} Y = (\mathrm{GL}_r \times Y)/H_{\mathbb{V}}$$

where the $H_{\mathbb{V}}$ -action is $h \cdot (g, y) = (g \cdot h, h^{-1} \cdot y)$. Furthermore, the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{GL}_r \times^{H_{\mathbb{V}}} Y & \longrightarrow & U \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ Y//H_{\mathbb{V}} & \longrightarrow & U//\mathrm{GL}_r \end{array}$$

is cartesian with two horizontal maps étale. This induces the following cartesian diagram of quotient stacks by restricting to GL_r -invariant W

$$\begin{array}{ccc} [(W \cap Y)/H_{\mathbb{V}}] & \longrightarrow & [W/\mathrm{GL}_r] \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ (W \cap Y)//H_{\mathbb{V}} & \longrightarrow & Z \end{array}$$

and étaleness of the bottom horizontal map then gives an isomorphism $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Z,\mathbb{V}} \simeq \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}^{H_{\mathbb{V}}}$. Now, notice that $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}$ is a miniversal algebra for $\mathcal{M}_B$ [AHR20, Remark 4.17], and

$$[W/\mathrm{GL}_r] \times_{\mathcal{M}_B} Y \simeq [W/\mathrm{GL}_r] \times_{\mathcal{M}_B} R_B \times_{R_B} Y \simeq W \cap Y$$

It follows that the map $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}$ is the base change of the miniversal family $\mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}_B(X, r)$ along $[W/\mathrm{GL}_r] \hookrightarrow \mathcal{M}_B$. Then, by [BBT24, Lemma 4.59] and the fact that W is Hodge at $(\mathbb{V}, \phi)$, $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}$ must be a quotient of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras; the pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra on the miniversal $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}$ is given by [BBT24, Theorem 4.3].

Let $e \in H_{\mathbb{V}}$ be the identity. We have a pullback diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{H_{\mathbb{V}},e} \times \mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)} & \xrightarrow{(s,t)} & \mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)} \times \mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{M}_B(X, r) & \xrightarrow{\Delta} & \mathcal{M}_B(X, r) \times \mathcal{M}_B(X, r) \end{array} \quad (3.4)$$

and by [BBT24, Theorem 4.3(3)] there is a unique pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra structure on $\mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{H_{\mathbb{V}},e} \times \mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}$ making (s, t) a morphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras. Notice that (s, t) gives the formal groupoid action of $\hat{H}_{\mathbb{V},e} = \mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{H_{\mathbb{V}},e}$ on $\mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}$, hence (or alternatively using [Alp12, §4]) we have

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}^{H_{\mathbb{V}}} &\simeq \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}^{\hat{H}_{\mathbb{V},e}} \\ &\simeq \ker(s^* - t^* : \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)} \otimes \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{H_{\mathbb{V}},e}) \end{aligned}$$

Since s^*, t^* are morphisms of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -algebras with $\mathrm{MHS}_{\mathbb{C}}$ abelian, we get an induced pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra structure on $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Z,\mathbb{V}} \simeq \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{W \cap Y,(\mathbb{V},\phi)}^{H_{\mathbb{V}}}$, as desired. $\square$

With this pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra structure on the good moduli space $M_B(X, r)$, we have a version of Corollary 3.10 for $M_B(X, 2)$ instead of the framed space $R_B(X, x, 2)$, as follows.

Corollary 3.12. *Using the notation of [Section 2.5](#), let Z be an irreducible component of the reduced image $\bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq M_B(X, 2)$. Let C be an irreducible component of $\phi_\chi^{-1}(Z) \subset M_B(X, 2, \det = \chi) \times A$, and denote*

$$T := \overline{\text{pr}_2(C)}_{\text{red}}$$

the Zariski closure of the reduced image of the projection onto $A = M_B(X, 1)$. Then T is a torsion-translated subtorus of A .

Furthermore, if $\mathbb{L} \in T$ is a unitary point, then $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T, \mathbb{L}}$ underlies a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra such that for every $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}) \in C$ underlying $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS, $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T, \mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C, (\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})}$ is a morphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras.

Proof. Firstly, the image of pr_2 is the same whether we work with $M_B(X, 2)$ or $R_B(X, x, 2)$, hence T is still a torsion-translated subtorus of A . Secondly, every such irreducible component Z is the good moduli image of some irreducible component W of $\Sigma_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq R_B(X, x, 2)$. Next, since the miniversal pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra structure of [\[BBT24, Theorem 4.3\]](#) is compatible with tensor product, and that the proof of [Proposition 3.11](#) is clearly functorial with respect to the inclusion of Hodge subvarieties $W \subseteq R_B(X, x, r)$, we get that

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{M_B(X, 2, \det = \chi), \mathbb{V}} \hat{\otimes} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{A, \mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C, (\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})}$$

is a quotient of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras for when $\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}$ underlie weight 0 complex variation of Hodge structures. Then the same proof as in [Corollary 3.10](#) works. $\square$

3.4. Hodge structures on normalization. The goal of this section is to show that if we have a normalization $C^\nu \rightarrow C$, and $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})$ is a $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS point of C , then for every $c \in C^\nu$ lying over $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})$ there is a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra structure on $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu, c}$ as well. We will start with some algebra facts.

Lemma 3.13. *Let $\phi : (A, \mathfrak{m}_A) \rightarrow (B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ be a finite homomorphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras, with $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A)$ and $(B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ complete local domains. Assume further that*

$$\mathfrak{m}_A = W_{-1}A, \quad W_0A = A$$

then $W_0B = B$ and $\mathfrak{m}_B = W_{-1}B$ as well.

Proof. We have the functorial Deligne splitting [\[PS08, Lemma-Definition 3.4\]](#) for the weight filtrations on A on B , giving $A \simeq \prod_{w \in \mathbb{Z}_{\leq 0}} A_w$, $B \simeq \prod_{w \in \mathbb{Z}} B_w$, and a finite map

$$\bar{\phi} : \prod_{w \in \mathbb{Z}_{\leq 0}} A_w \rightarrow \prod_{w \in \mathbb{Z}} B_w$$

compatible with the weights. Let $0 \neq b \in B_w$ be a homogeneous element, then b is integral, say of degree d , over $\prod_{w \in \mathbb{Z}_{\leq 0}} A_w$. Take the dw -homogeneous part of the monic polynomial for b , we get

$$b^d + a_1 b^{d-1} + \cdots + a_d = 0$$

with $a_j \in A_{jw}$. If $w > 0$ then $A_{jw} = 0$ hence $a_j = 0$ and $b^d = 0$ which gives a contradiction since A is a domain. If $w = 0$ then all $a_j \in A_0 = \mathbb{C}$ hence $b \in \mathbb{C}$. It follows that $W_{-1}B = \mathfrak{m}_B$ and $W_0B = B$. $\square$

Lemma 3.14. *Let B be a complete noetherian local pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra with $W_{-1}B = \mathfrak{m}_B$. Then the ideal of the reduced singular locus $I(\text{Sing}(\text{Spec } B)_{\text{red}})$ is a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-ideal of B .*

Proof. This follows from the proof of [BBT24, Lemma 8.23] which implies that $I(\text{Sing}(\text{Spec } B))$ is a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-ideal of B , and [BBT24, Lemma 4.36] which says that taking the reduction preserves the Hodge structure. $\square$

Lemma 3.15. *Let $(B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ be a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra which is a complete noetherian local domain, and $I \subset B$ a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-ideal. Then $\text{End}_B(I)$ underlies a local pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra structure such that the natural map defined by multiplication*

$$B \rightarrow \text{End}_B(I)$$

is an finite injective morphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras.

Proof. Write

$$B = \varprojlim B/\mathfrak{m}_B^{n+1} = \varprojlim B_n, \quad I = \varprojlim I/\mathfrak{m}_B^{n+1}I = \varprojlim I_n$$

then each $\text{End}_{B_n}(I_n)$ is just the kernel of the morphism of $\mathbb{C}$ -MHS

$$\text{End}_{\mathbb{C}}(I_n) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(B_n \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} I_n, I_n)$$

hence carries the structure of an artinian local $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra. Next, we have tensor-Hom adjunction

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{MHS}_{\mathbb{C}}}(B_n \otimes I_n, I_n) \simeq \text{Hom}_{\text{MHS}_{\mathbb{C}}}(B_n, \text{End}_{\mathbb{C}}(I_n))$$

under which the multiplication map $B_n \rightarrow \text{End}_{\mathbb{C}}(I_n)$ corresponds to the B_n -module structure map $B_n \otimes I_n \rightarrow I_n$ which is a morphism of $\mathbb{C}$ -MHS since I_n is a $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-ideal of B_n . Hence $B_n \rightarrow \text{End}_{\mathbb{C}}(I_n)$ is a morphism of $\mathbb{C}$ -MHS which factors through $B_n \rightarrow \text{End}_{B_n}(I_n)$ in $\text{MHS}_{\mathbb{C}}$. The kernel is $\text{Ann}_{B_n}(I_n) = 0$ since B is a domain.

The map $\text{End}_B(I) \rightarrow \text{End}_{B_n}(I_n)$ is not surjective, and with kernel

$$K_n = \{f \in \text{End}_B(I) \mid f(I) \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_B^{n+1}I\}$$

Let $\langle x_1, \dots, x_l \rangle$ be a generating set of I as a B -module. Then the map

$$\text{End}_B(I) \rightarrow I^l, \quad f \mapsto (f(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_l))$$

is an injection, and gives $K_n = \text{End}_B(I) \cap \mathfrak{m}_B^{n+1}I^l$. By [AM69, Theorem 10.11], the two filtrations $\mathfrak{m}_B^{\bullet+1}\text{End}_B(I)$ and $K_{\bullet}$ are cofinal. Thus we can take the inverse limit of the first part of the proof to get the desired statements. $\square$

Proposition 3.16. *Let Λ be a reduced complete noetherian local $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra which underlies a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra such that $\mathfrak{m}_{\Lambda} = W_{-1}\Lambda$. For every minimal prime $\mathfrak{p} \subset \Lambda$, denote $A = \Lambda/\mathfrak{p}$ and A^{ν} its normalization. Then A^{ν} underlies a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra structure with*

$$W_0A^{\nu} = A^{\nu}, \quad W_{-1}A^{\nu} = \mathfrak{m}_{\nu}$$

such that the normalization map $\nu : A \rightarrow A^\nu$ and its composition $\Lambda \rightarrow A^\nu$ are morphisms of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras.

Proof. We will make use Oka's criterion for normality [GR84, Chapter 6 §5.2], which says that for a reduced ring B , B is normal if and only if the multiplication map

$$B \rightarrow \text{End}_B(I(\text{Sing}(\text{Spec } B)_{\text{red}}))$$

is an isomorphism. Start with $B^0 = A = \Lambda/\mathfrak{p}$ which is a domain, and define recursively

$$B^{j+1} = \text{End}_{B^j}(I(\text{Sing}(\text{Spec } B^j)_{\text{red}}))$$

then each $B^{j+1} \subseteq A^\nu$ and is finite. We will prove this by induction. Denote $I^j = I(\text{Sing}(\text{Spec } B^j)_{\text{red}})$. Suppose $B^j \subseteq A^\nu$ is a domain and $\text{Frac}(B^j) = \text{Frac}(A)$, which is automatically satisfied for $j = 0$. Pick $0 \neq b \in I^j$, then for

$$f \in \text{End}_{B^j}(I^j)$$

$f(b)/b \in \text{Frac}(A)$. We get that $f(b') = \frac{f(b)}{b}f(b')$ for all $b' \in I^j$, which gives an embedding $\text{End}_{B^j}(I^j) \hookrightarrow \text{Frac}(A)$ by $f \mapsto f(b)/b$. Thus we get

$$B^j \subseteq \text{End}_{B^j}(I^j) = B^{j+1} \subseteq \text{Frac}(A)$$

where the first inclusion is by the multiplication map and the fact that B^j is a domain. Finally B^{j+1} is finite over B^j hence $B^{j+1} \subseteq A^\nu$ as well. We have a chain

$$A \subseteq B^1 \subseteq B^2 \subseteq \dots \subseteq A^\nu$$

which must stabilize due to noetherian assumption. At the stable stage we get $B^j \simeq \text{End}_{B^j}(I^j)$ hence $B^j = (B^j)^\nu = A^\nu$.

By [BBT24, Lemma 4.36], $\Lambda \rightarrow A = \Lambda/\mathfrak{p}$ is a morphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras. By Lemma 3.14 and Lemma 3.15, the inclusions

$$A \subseteq B^1 \subseteq B^2 \subseteq \dots \subseteq A^\nu$$

are all morphisms of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras. It follows that $A \rightarrow A^\nu$ is a morphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras, which is a finite map hence by Lemma 3.13 we get the weight statements. $\square$

Corollary 3.17. *Using the notation of Section 2.5, let Z be an irreducible component of the reduced image $\bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq M_B(X, 2)$. Let C be an irreducible component of $\phi_\chi^{-1}(Z) \subset M_B(X, 2, \det = \chi) \times A$, and $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}) \in C$ a $\mathbb{C}$ -VHS point. Consider the normalization $\nu : C^\nu \rightarrow C$ with c lying over $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})$, then $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu, c}$ underlies a pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebra with*

$$W_0 \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu, c} = \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu, c}, \quad W_{-1} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu, c} = \mathfrak{m}_{C^\nu, c}$$

such that the map $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C, (\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu, c}$ is a morphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras.

Proof. Any such $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu, c}$ would be isomorphic to $\left(\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C, (\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})}/\mathfrak{p}\right)^\nu$ for some minimal prime $\mathfrak{p}$. Proposition 3.16 then gives the desired statements. $\square$

4. VIRTUALLY ABELIAN JUMP COMPONENTS

Let $\Sigma_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq R_B(X, x, 2)$ be a jump locus, and $\bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq M_B(X, 2)$ be the reduced good moduli image. Denote $Z \subseteq \bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2)$ an irreducible component. We first justify labeling Z based on its general point.

4.1. Generic projective type. Consider the following algebraic subgroups of PGL_2 :

$$B = \mathrm{Stab}(\infty) = \left\{ \left[\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & d \end{pmatrix} \right] \mid ad \neq 0 \right\} \quad (4.1)$$

$$T_{0,\infty} = \mathrm{Stab}(\infty) \cap \mathrm{Stab}(0) = \left\{ \left[\begin{pmatrix} a & 0 \\ 0 & d \end{pmatrix} \right] \mid ad \neq 0 \right\} \quad (4.2)$$

$$D_\infty = T_{0,\infty} \cup \left\{ \left[\begin{pmatrix} 0 & b \\ c & 0 \end{pmatrix} \right] \mid bc \neq 0 \right\} \quad (4.3)$$

where square bracket denotes the projective class. Notice that $T_{0,\infty}$ is an algebraic torus, D_∞ is the normalizer of $T_{0,\infty}$, fixes the set of points $\{0, \infty\} \subset \mathbb{P}^1$ and is $D_\infty \simeq T_{0,\infty} \rtimes \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$.

Let $\rho : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ be a semisimple representation, and $\bar{\rho} : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ its projective quotient. Denote the Zariski closure

$$G_{\bar{\rho}} := \overline{\bar{\rho}(\pi_1(X, x))}^{\mathrm{Zar}} \subseteq \mathrm{PGL}_2$$

the algebraic monodromy group of $\bar{\rho}$.

Lemma 4.1. *For each semisimple $\rho : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{C})$, exactly one of the following is true:*

- (A): ρ is reducible, i.e., $\rho \simeq \chi_1 \oplus \chi_2$;
- (B): ρ is irreducible, and, up to conjugation, $G_{\bar{\rho}} \subseteq D_\infty$;
- (C): $G_{\bar{\rho}} \simeq \bar{\rho}(\pi_1(X, x)) \simeq A_4, S_4$ or A_5 ;
- (D): $\bar{\rho}$ has Zariski dense image and is rigid;
- (E): $\bar{\rho}$ has Zariski dense image and is non-rigid.

Proof. ρ is reducible if and only if it fixes a line, or equivalently, $G_{\bar{\rho}}$ fixes a point in $\mathbb{P}^1$. Up to conjugation, this is equivalent to $G_{\bar{\rho}}$ being contained in the Borel B . The fact that this classification is exhaustive follows from [NPT08, Theorem 1].

For mutual exclusivity, it is clear that (A), (B), (D), and (E) are mutually exclusive; same for (C), (D) and (E). For (B), and (C), notice that the only finite subgroups of $D_\infty = T_{0,\infty} \rtimes \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ is either dihedral D_n or a cyclic group. Finally for (A) and (E), a finite subgroup fixing a point must fix another (it acts as an affine transformation on $\mathbb{A}^1$), hence, up to conjugation, is contained in the torus $T_{0,\infty}$. It follows that it must be cyclic. $\square$

We will show that a general point of an irreducible component must be of exactly one of the previous 5 types. In other words, we cannot have two types whose points are both dense in the component. It suffices to show that each type is a locally closed condition.

Definition 4.2. Denote

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{D} &\subset M_B(X, 2) \text{ be } \bigcup_{0 \neq \epsilon \in \text{Hom}(\pi_1, \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z})} \mathfrak{D}_\epsilon \text{ as in Lemma 4.6,} \\ \mathfrak{R} &\subset M_B(X, 2) \text{ the locus of reducible representations,} \\ \mathfrak{F} &\subset M_B(X, 2) \text{ the locus of representations of type (C),} \\ \mathfrak{G} &\subset M_B(X, 2) \text{ the locus of projectively dense representations.} \end{aligned}$$

then $M_B(X, 2) = \mathfrak{R} \cup \mathfrak{D} \cup \mathfrak{F} \cup \mathfrak{G}$.

Proposition 4.3. *Let Z be an irreducible component of $\overline{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2)$, the reduced good moduli image of $\Sigma_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq R_B(X, x, 2)$. Then Z has a nonempty Zariski open subset on which exactly one of the types in Lemma 4.1 occurs. If the type is (A), (B), or (C), then Z is contained in, respectively, $\mathfrak{R}$, $\mathfrak{D}$ or $\mathfrak{F}$.*

Proof. The locus of type (A) is $\mathfrak{R}$, which is closed by Lemma 4.4. The locus of type (C) is closed by (4.7). The locus of type (B) is open in $\mathfrak{D}$ by Lemma 4.6. Type (D) locus is closed in $\mathfrak{G}$, since it is a finite union of images of θ_ρ as defined in Lemma 4.8; this is because there are only finitely many rigid points in $M_B(X, \text{PGL}_2)$. Finally the locus of type (E) is open in $\mathfrak{G}$ hence open. $\square$

4.2. Reducible jump component.

Lemma 4.4. *Let $A = M_B(X, 1)$, then the map*

$$\iota : (A \times A)/S_2 \rightarrow M_B(X, 2), \quad (\chi_1, \chi_2) \mapsto [\chi_1 \oplus \chi_2] \quad (4.4)$$

is a closed embedding, with image the reducible locus $\mathfrak{R}$.

Proof. These are both affine schemes, and the corresponding map of rings is

$$\iota^\# : H^0(R_B(X, x, 2), \mathcal{O}_{R_B})^{\text{GL}_2} \rightarrow (H^0(A, \mathcal{O}_A) \otimes H^0(A, \mathcal{O}_A))^{S_2}$$

mapping

$$f \mapsto \left[(\chi_1, \chi_2) \mapsto f \left(\gamma \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} \chi_1(\gamma) & 0 \\ 0 & \chi_2(\gamma) \end{pmatrix} \right) \right]$$

where f is a function on $\text{Hom}(\pi_1(X, x), \text{GL}_2)$. Notice that $H^0(A, \mathcal{O}_A) \otimes H^0(A, \mathcal{O}_A)$ is generated by the functions

$$\gamma^1 : (\chi_1, \chi_2) \mapsto \chi_1(\gamma), \quad \gamma^2 : (\chi_1, \chi_2) \mapsto \chi_2(\gamma) \quad \gamma \in \pi_1(X, x)$$

i.e., every regular function on $A \times A$ has the form $\sum \gamma^1 \delta^2$ with $\gamma, \delta \in \pi_1(X, x)$. Let $1 \neq \sigma \in S_2$, then $\sigma^*(\gamma^1 \delta^2) = \delta^1 \gamma^2$. The S_2 -invariant functions are then generated by

$$\gamma^1 \delta^2 + \delta^1 \gamma^2 \quad \delta, \gamma \in \pi_1(X, x)$$

Next, notice that the trace functionals

$$\text{tr}_\gamma : R_B(X, x, 2) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}, \quad \rho \mapsto \text{tr}(\rho(\gamma))$$

are GL_2 -invariant and satisfies $\iota^\#(\text{tr}_\gamma) = \gamma^1 + \gamma^2$, hence

$$\iota^\#(\text{tr}_\gamma \text{tr}_\delta - \text{tr}_{\gamma\delta}) = \gamma^1 \delta^2 + \delta^1 \gamma^2$$

thus $\iota^\#$ is a quotient map. As a result, ι is a closed embedding. $\square$

Let $q : A \times A \rightarrow (A \times A)/S_2$ be the quotient. Since $H^i(X, \chi_1 \oplus \chi_2) = H^i(X, \chi_1) \oplus H^i(X, \chi_2)$, we get that

$$\bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2) \cap \mathfrak{R} = \iota \left(\bigcup_{a+b=k} \Sigma_a^i(X, 1) \times \Sigma_b^i(X, 1) \right) \quad (4.5)$$

which is a finite union of images under q of products of torsion-translated subtori, by [Corollary 2.17](#).

Proposition 4.5. *Let Z be an irreducible component of $\bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2)$, the reduced good moduli image of $\Sigma_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq R_B(X, x, 2)$. If the general point of Z is reducible, then there is a product $N = N_1 \times N_2 \subseteq M_B(X, 1) \times M_B(X, 1)$ of torsion-translated subtori such that*

$$\begin{cases} Z^\nu \simeq N_1 \times N_2 & \text{if } N_1 \neq N_2 \\ Z \simeq \text{Sym}^2(N_1) & \text{if } N_1 = N_2 \end{cases}$$

Proof. Since $\mathfrak{R}$ is closed, $Z \subset \mathfrak{R}$. Z is an irreducible component, hence it picks out one component $N = \Sigma_a^i(X, 1) \times \Sigma_b^i(X, 1)$ in (4.5). It follows that $Z = \iota(q(N))$ hence $Z \simeq q(N)$.

If $N_1 \neq N_2$ then $N_1 \cap \sigma N_2$ is closed subset of N_1 , for $1 \neq \sigma \in S_2$. Therefore the map $N_1 \times N_2 \rightarrow q(N_1 \times N_2)$ is finite, surjective with generic degree 1. It follows that it must be the normalization. If $N_1 = N_2$ then $q(N_1 \times N_1) \simeq \text{Sym}^2(N_1)$. $\square$

4.3. Dihedral jump component. If, up to conjugation, $G_{\bar{\rho}} \subseteq D_\infty$ then ρ fixes a set of two lines $\{l_1, l_2\}$ with $l_1 \oplus l_2 \simeq \mathbb{C}^2$. Each $\rho(\gamma)(l_i) \in \{l_1, l_2\}$ hence we get a permutation character

$$\epsilon : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$$

If $\epsilon \neq 0$ (equivalently, ρ is of type **(B)**), $\rho|_{\ker \epsilon}$ then fixes both line hence $\rho|_{\ker \epsilon} \simeq \chi_1 \oplus \chi_2$. An element $\delta \in \pi_1(X, x) \setminus \ker \epsilon$ has nontrivial $\epsilon(\delta)$. Conjugation by δ on $\ker \epsilon \trianglelefteq \pi_1(X, x)$ then permutes χ_1 and χ_2 .

Now pick any $0 \neq \epsilon \in \text{Hom}(\pi_1(X, x), \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z})$, and denote

$$A^\epsilon := \text{Hom}(\ker \epsilon, \mathbb{G}_m)$$

then conjugation by any $\delta \in \pi_1(X, x) \setminus \ker \epsilon$ on $\ker \epsilon \trianglelefteq \pi_1(X, x)$, denoted $\tau : \ker \epsilon \rightarrow \ker \epsilon$, induces an involution τ^* on A^ϵ . This is because $\delta^2 = 0$; the choice of δ does not matter.

Lemma 4.6. *Induction gives a morphism*

$$\iota_\epsilon : A^\epsilon / \langle \tau^* \rangle \rightarrow M_B(X, 2), \quad [\chi] \mapsto [\text{Ind}_{\ker \epsilon}^{\pi_1(X, x)} \chi]$$

*which is a closed embedding with image $\mathfrak{D}_\epsilon$. The irreducible points in the image correspond to representations of type **(B)** with the permutation character ϵ , and form a Zariski open subset of $\mathfrak{D}_\epsilon$.*

Proof. The corresponding map on rings is

$$\iota_\epsilon^\# : H^0(R_B(X, x, 2), \mathcal{O}_{R_B})^{\text{GL}_2} \rightarrow H^0(A^\epsilon, \mathcal{O}_{A^\epsilon})^{\tau^*}$$

mapping $f \mapsto \left[\chi \mapsto f \left(\text{Ind}_{\ker \epsilon}^{\pi_1(X, x)} \chi \right) \right]$. Explicitly, with the same δ as before, and $\rho = \text{Ind}_{\ker \epsilon}^{\pi_1(X, x)} \chi$,

$$\begin{aligned} \rho(\gamma) &= \begin{pmatrix} \chi(\gamma) & 0 \\ 0 & \chi(\delta^{-1}\gamma\delta) \end{pmatrix}, \quad \gamma \in \ker(\epsilon) \\ \rho(\delta') &= \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \chi(\delta h \delta) \\ \chi(h) & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \delta' \in \pi_1(X, x) \setminus \ker \epsilon, \delta' = \delta \cdot h \end{aligned}$$

Now, regular functions on A^ϵ are generated by those of the form $\gamma : \chi \mapsto \chi(\gamma)$ with $\gamma \in \ker(\epsilon)$. Thus τ^* -invariant functions are generated by

$$\gamma^\tau : \chi \mapsto \chi(\gamma) + \chi(\delta^{-1}\gamma\delta), \quad \gamma \in \ker(\epsilon)$$

which are clearly $\iota_\epsilon^\#(\text{tr}_\gamma)$ hence $\iota_\epsilon^\#$ is a quotient map.

Notice that $\iota_\epsilon(\chi)|_{\ker \epsilon} = \chi \oplus \tau^*\chi$. If $\chi \neq \tau^*\chi$ then the only possible invariant line must be generated by either basis vectors, i.e., $\mathbb{C} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$ or $\mathbb{C} \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$. However, any element in $\pi_1(X, x) \setminus \ker \epsilon$ swaps these two lines, thus there is no invariant line and ι_ϵ is of type **(B)**. By the discussion at the beginning of the section, this gives all type **(B)** representations with permutation character ϵ .

Now if $\chi = \tau^*\chi$ then for $\gamma \in \ker \epsilon$ and $\delta' = \delta \cdot h \in \pi_1(X, x) \setminus \ker \epsilon$,

$$\iota_\epsilon(\chi)(\gamma) = \chi(\gamma) \cdot \text{Id}, \quad \iota_\epsilon(\delta') = \chi(h) \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \chi(\delta^2) \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

then the eigendecomposition for $\iota_\epsilon(\delta')$, which is independent of h hence independent of $\delta' \in \pi_1(X, x) \setminus \ker \epsilon$, gives a decomposition of $\iota_\epsilon(\chi)$. Finally, the set of χ fixed by $\tau^*(\chi)$ is closed, hence we get the Zariski open statement. $\square$

For $0 \neq \epsilon \in \text{Hom}(\pi_1(X, x), \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z})$, let $\pi^\epsilon : X^\epsilon \rightarrow X$ be the connected étale double cover coming from $\ker \epsilon \triangleleft \pi_1(X, x)$. For $\chi \in A^\epsilon$ with the corresponding local system $\mathbb{L}$ on X^ϵ , $\text{Ind}_{\ker \epsilon}^{\pi_1(X, x)} \chi$ corresponds to the local system $\pi_*^\epsilon \mathbb{L}$ on X . By a straightforward application of Leray's spectral sequence,

$$H^i(X, \text{Ind}_{\ker \epsilon}^{\pi_1(X, x)} \chi) \simeq H^i(X^\epsilon, \chi) \quad (4.6)$$

and we get the following consequence for a type **(B)** jump component.

Proposition 4.7. *Let Z be an irreducible component of $\overline{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2)$, the reduced good moduli image of $\Sigma_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq R_B(X, x, 2)$. If the general point of Z is of type **(B)**, then there exists a torsion-translated subtorus $N \subseteq M_B(X^\epsilon, 1)$ such that either $Z^\nu \simeq N$ or, if $\tau^*N = N$, $Z \simeq N/\langle \tau^* \rangle$.*

Proof. Since Z is irreducible, and its general point is of type **(B)**, it must lie in some $\mathfrak{D}_\epsilon$ in Lemma 4.6. By (4.6), it must be the image of an irreducible component N of $\Sigma_k^i(X^\epsilon, 1)$, hence N is a torsion-translated subtorus by Corollary 2.17. If N is τ^* -invariant, then since ι_ϵ is a closed embedding, $Z \simeq N/\langle \tau^* \rangle$. If N is not τ^* -invariant, then $N \cap \tau^*N$ is closed in N , thus the composition $N \rightarrow A^\epsilon/\langle \tau^* \rangle \xrightarrow{\iota_\epsilon} Z$ is a finite map of generic degree 1, hence $N \simeq Z^\nu$. $\square$

4.4. Projectively finite and rigid jump components. Let $\mathbb{V}_\rho \in M_B(X, 2)$ be an irreducible semisimple representation with corresponding representation $\rho : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{C})$. Let $A = M_B(X, 1)$.

Lemma 4.8. *The morphism*

$$\theta_\rho : A \rightarrow M_B(X, 2), \quad \chi \mapsto [\rho \otimes \chi]$$

is finite, with fibers being the orbits of the finite group

$$K(\rho) = \{\chi \in A \mid \rho \otimes \chi \simeq \rho\} \subseteq A[2]$$

Proof. Consider the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} A & & \xrightarrow{\chi \mapsto \rho \otimes \chi} & & M_B(X, 2) \\ & \searrow \chi \mapsto (\rho \otimes \chi, \chi) & & \searrow \Phi & \\ & M_B(X, 2) \times_A A & \xrightarrow{\Phi} & & M_B(X, 2) \\ & \downarrow & & & \downarrow \det \\ & A & \xrightarrow{\chi \mapsto \det(\rho) \otimes \chi^{\otimes 2}} & & A \end{array}$$

then $A \rightarrow M_B(X, 2) \times_A A$ is a closed embedding, and Φ is finite since the horizontal $A \rightarrow A$ is finite. Thus θ_ρ , being the composition, is finite. For the fiber identification, notice that $\rho \otimes \chi \simeq \rho \chi'$ if and only if $\chi' \otimes \chi^{-1} \in K(\rho)$. $\square$

Let $\Gamma \in \{A_4, S_4, A_5\}$. Since $\pi_1(X, x)$ is finitely generated and Γ is finite, there are only finitely many homomorphism $\varphi : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \Gamma \subset \mathrm{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C})$. Since every subgroup of PGL_2 isomorphic to Γ is conjugate to the standard embedding, and we are working with M_B , there is no ambiguity with φ . Suppose φ has a GL_2 -lift $\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}$. Since any two lifts differ by a rank one twist, we get that

$$\mathfrak{F} = \bigcup_{\Gamma, \varphi} \theta_{\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}}(A) \subset M_B(X, 2) \quad (4.7)$$

with $\mathfrak{F}$ the locus of type **(C)** representations.

Proposition 4.9. *Let Z be an irreducible component of $\overline{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2)$, the reduced good moduli image of $\Sigma_k^i(X, 2)$. If the general point of Z is of type **(C)**, then there is a torsion-translated $N \subset A$ such that Z has a normalization*

$$Z^\nu = N/H$$

where $H = \{\chi \in K(\rho) \mid \chi N = N\}$. Consequently, Z^ν is a torsion-translated subtorus of A/H .

Proof. Since Z is irreducible, it must lie in some $\theta_{\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}}(A)$, with $\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}$ a GL_2 -lift of some $\varphi : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ with image Γ . We first claim that it is possible to pick $\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}$ with finite monodromy. Equivalently, there is some $\chi \in A$ such that $\chi \otimes \mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}$ has finite monodromy. Recall that every class in A/A^2 has a torsion lift

in A , and pick one such lift ϵ for $[\det \mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}] \in A/A^2$. We get that for some $\mathbb{L} \in A$, $\epsilon = \det(\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}) \otimes \mathbb{L}$. Then

$$\det(\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi} \otimes \mathbb{L}) = e$$

is torsion. It follows that $\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi} \otimes \mathbb{L}$ has finite monodromy projective quotient, and finite monodromy determinant. Since the map

$$\mathrm{GL}_2 \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}_2 \times \mathbb{G}_m, \quad g \mapsto ([g], \det g)$$

is finite of degree 2, we get that $\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi} \otimes \mathbb{L}$ has finite monodromy. In particular, $\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi} \otimes \mathbb{L}$ is of geometric origin.

We can now assume that $\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}$ is of geometric origin. Then $\theta_{\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}}^{-1}(Z)$ is an irreducible component of the twisted jump loci

$$\Sigma_k^i(X, \mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}, 1) = \{\chi \in A \mid \dim H^i(X, \mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi} \otimes \chi) \geq k\}$$

which is then a torsion-translated subtorus $N \subset A$ by [Corollary 2.17](#). It follows that $Z = \theta_{\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}}(N)$. Next, denote $H = \{\chi \in K(\rho) \mid \chi N = N\}$, then since H acts by translation, N/H is a translated subtorus of A/H . Finally, $N/H \rightarrow \theta_{\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}}(N)$ is finite of degree 1 (since the extra identifications come from the fixed loci of $\chi \in K(\rho)$ with $\chi N \neq N$; these fixed loci are closed proper subset of N). As a result, $N/H \rightarrow Z$ is the normalization map. $\square$

Proposition 4.10. *Let Z be an irreducible component of $\overline{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2)$, the reduced good moduli image of $\Sigma_k^i(X, 2)$. If the general point of Z is of type **(D)**. Then there exists a translated subtorus $N \subseteq A$ such that $Z^\nu \simeq N/H$ with $\{\chi \in K(\rho) \mid \chi N = N\}$.*

Proof. Here we must have $Z \subseteq \theta_{\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}}(A)$, with $\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}$ a GL_2 -lift of an isolated point in $M_B(X, \mathrm{PGL}_2)$. Hence it is the image under $\theta_{\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}}(A)$ of an irreducible component of

$$\Sigma_k^i(X, \mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}, 1) = \{\chi \in A \mid \dim H^i(X, \mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi} \otimes \chi) \geq k\}$$

hence it is $\theta_{\mathbb{V}_{\Gamma, \varphi}}(N)$ with $N \subseteq A$ a translated subtorus by [Corollary 2.17](#) (we lose that the translation is torsion). The remaining statements are exactly as in the proof of [Proposition 4.9](#). $\square$

5. NONABELIAN JUMP COMPONENT

This section will handle the remaining case from the previous section, i.e., Z is an irreducible component of $\overline{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2)$ with general point of type **(E)** (see [Lemma 4.1](#)). Let $A = M_B(X, 1)$. Following [Section 2.5](#), Z is contained in some $M_B(X, 2, \det \in \epsilon A^2)$ with torsion $\epsilon \in A$. Pick an irreducible component

$$\begin{array}{ccc} C \subseteq \Phi_\epsilon^{-1}(Z) \subseteq M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \times A & & \\ \text{pr}_1 \downarrow & \searrow \text{pr}_2 & \\ M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) & & A \end{array} \tag{5.1}$$

then by [Proposition 2.19](#), the normalized $C^\nu \rightarrow Z^\nu$ is a finite étale torsor.

First we take a detour to talk about local systems and cohomology on a Deligne-Mumford quotient stack.

5.1. Local systems on finite quotient curves. We are following the exposition in [CS08, §2.1 and 2.2]. For more details, see [Noo04].

Definition 5.1. A *DM curve* is a connected smooth one-dimensional complex Deligne-Mumford stack, and an *orbicurve* is a DM curve with trivial generic stabilizer.

In this paper, we work only with DM curves $\mathcal{Y}$ of the form $\mathcal{Y} = [Y/G]$ where Y is a connected smooth projective curve and G is a finite group acting on Y .

Definition 5.2. Let $\bar{y} \in \mathcal{Y}$ be a point, then we have the fundamental group $\pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$. For $y \in Y$ lying over $\bar{y} \in \mathcal{Y}$ in the étale map

$$\pi : Y \rightarrow \mathcal{Y} = [Y/G]$$

an element of $\pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$ is a pair (g, γ) with $g \in G$ and γ a path from y to $g \cdot y$. Thus we have an exact sequence

$$1 \rightarrow \pi_1(Y, y) \rightarrow \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y}) \rightarrow G \rightarrow 1$$

Definition 5.3. A complex local system on $\mathcal{Y}$ is a G -equivariant local system on Y , i.e. a pair $(\mathbb{V}, \alpha)$ where $\mathbb{V}$ is a local system on Y and α is an action associating to each $g \in G$ an isomorphism $\alpha_g : g^* \mathbb{V} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{V}$ such that

$$\alpha_g \circ g^* \alpha_h = \alpha_{gh}, \quad g, h \in G$$

Then we recover the familiar equivalence [Noo05, Theorem 18.19]

$$\mathrm{Loc}^G(Y) \simeq \mathrm{Loc}_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{Y}) \simeq \mathrm{Rep}_{\mathbb{C}}(\pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y}))$$

between complex local systems on $\mathcal{Y}$ and complex representations of $\pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$.

We have similar definitions for constructible complexes and perverse sheaves, i.e. $D_c^b(\mathcal{Y}, \mathbb{C}) = D_c^{b,G}(Y, \mathbb{C})$ and $\mathrm{Perv}(\mathcal{Y}) = \mathrm{Perv}^G(Y)$. For $K \in D_c^b(\mathcal{Y}, \mathbb{C})$, $\mathrm{R}\Gamma(\mathcal{Y}, K) \simeq \mathrm{R}\Gamma(Y, \pi^* K)^G$.

Definition 5.4. Since $\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{Y}) \simeq \mathrm{Rep}_{\mathbb{C}}(\pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y}))$, we have framed character varieties of $\mathcal{Y}$,

$$R_B(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y}, r) := \mathrm{Hom}(\pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y}), \mathrm{GL}_r)$$

which are affine schemes. Its affine good moduli space is the GIT quotient

$$M_B(\mathcal{Y}, r) := R_B(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y}, r) // \mathrm{GL}_r = \mathrm{Spec} H^0(R_B(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y}, r), \mathcal{O}_{R_B})^{\mathrm{GL}_r}$$

by the conjugation action.

For $y \in Y$ let $G_y = \{g \in G \mid g \cdot y = y\}$ be the stabilizer group. Notice that replacing y by $g \cdot y$ identifies G_y with G_{gy} by conjugation, which then gives a canonical isomorphism

$$M_B(BG_y, r) \simeq M_B(BG_{gy}, r)$$

where $BH = [\mathrm{Spec} \mathbb{C}/H]$. Denote $I_\eta = \ker(G \rightarrow \mathrm{Aut}(Y))$ the generic inertia, then for general $y \in Y$, $G_y = I_\eta$. There are finitely many exceptional points $y \in Y$ with $I_\eta \subsetneq G_y$; pick their G -orbit representatives $y_1, \dots, y_l$ with $G_j = G_{y_j}$. Pulling back along the residual gerbes $\iota_j : BG_j \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ gives

$$\iota_j^* : M_B(\mathcal{Y}, r) \rightarrow M_B(BG_j, r), \quad 0 \leq j \leq l$$

where $\iota_0 : BI_\eta \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ be the residual gerbe of a generic $y \in Y$. Since I_η acts trivially on Y , ι_0^* does not depend on the choice of general point.

Definition 5.5. For $\tau = (\tau_j) \in \prod_{1 \leq j \leq l} M_B(BG_j, r)$, we define the *fixed-inertia locus* to be

$$M_B(\mathcal{Y}, r, \tau) = \bigcap_{0 \leq j \leq l} \iota_j^*(\tau_j)$$

Since $M_B(BG_j, r)$ is finite and reduced for G_j finite, we get that every irreducible subvariety of $M_B(\mathcal{Y}, r)$ lies in one such fixed-inertia locus.

Proposition 5.6. For $\pi : Y \rightarrow \mathcal{Y} = [Y/G]$ we have the following

- (1) If $j : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ is a nonempty open substack, then $j_* : \pi_1(\mathcal{U}, \bar{u}) \rightarrow \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{u})$ is surjective. Consequently restriction of local systems from $\mathcal{Y}$ to $\mathcal{U}$ is fully faithful and preserves irreducibility.
- (2) If $f : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ induces surjection on fundamental groups, then

$$f^* : M_B(\mathcal{Y}, r) \rightarrow M_B(\mathcal{X}, r)$$

is a closed immersion.

Proof. Let $U = \mathcal{U} \times_{\mathcal{Y}} Y$ then U is a G -invariant subset of Y , and we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 1 & \longrightarrow & \pi_1(U, u) & \longrightarrow & \pi_1(\mathcal{U}, \bar{u}) & \longrightarrow & G \longrightarrow 1 \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \parallel \\ 1 & \longrightarrow & \pi_1(Y, u) & \longrightarrow & \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{u}) & \longrightarrow & G \longrightarrow 1 \end{array}$$

where the left vertical surjection comes from $Y \setminus U$ being finitely many points. Thus we get a surjection $\pi_1(\mathcal{U}, \bar{u}) \twoheadrightarrow \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{u})$. The second statement (2) is exactly the same as for character varieties of varieties. $\square$

5.2. A factorization theorem following Corlette-Simpson. With the notations in (5.1), let

$$D = \overline{\text{pr}_1(C)}_{\text{red}} \subset M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon), \quad T = \overline{\text{pr}_2(C)}_{\text{red}} \subset A$$

with T a torsion-translated subtorus, and $\epsilon \in A$ torsion. Notice that since a general point of Z has dense PGL_2 -image, the same is true for D .

Remark 5.7. We can look at the image of D under $\mathbb{P} : M_B(X, 2) \rightarrow M_B(X, \text{PGL}_2)$. If the image is zero-dimensional, then D itself must be finite since two fixed-determinant lifts of a PGL_2 -representation differs by an element of $A[2]$ which is finite. Since C is irreducible, we must have $D = \{\mathbb{V}\}$ and $C = \{\mathbb{V}\} \times T$. From now on, we assume that $\mathbb{P}(D)$ is positive-dimensional in $M_B(X, \text{PGL}_2)$.

The goal of this section is the following proposition:

Proposition 5.8. *There is a proper hyperbolic DM curve $\mathcal{Y} = [Y/G]$ and a morphism $s : X \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ and an irreducible component Q of a fixed-determinant, fixed-inertia locus $M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 2, \det = \delta, \tau)$ such that*

- (1) $s_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$ is a surjection.
(2) with the closed embedding $s^* : M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 2) \hookrightarrow M_B(X, 2)$, $D \subseteq s^*(Q)$.

Let $p : X^\epsilon \rightarrow X$ be the connected finite étale cover corresponding to $\ker \epsilon \triangleleft \pi_1(X, x)$. Then for every $\rho \in D \subset M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon)$, the restriction $\rho|_{X^\epsilon} \in M_B(X^\epsilon, \mathrm{SL}_2)$. Call this map $\mathrm{res}_\epsilon : M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \rightarrow M_B(X^\epsilon, \mathrm{SL}_2)$.

Lemma 5.9. *The general point of $\mathrm{res}_\epsilon(D)$ has Zariski-dense image in SL_2 , and is non-rigid.*

Proof. We start with some claims.

Claim. *If $\bar{\rho} : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ has Zariski-dense image in PGL_2 and $\Gamma \triangleleft \pi_1(X, x)$ a normal finite-index subgroup, then $\bar{\rho}(\Gamma)$ is Zariski-dense in PGL_2 .*

Proof of Claim. Let $H = \overline{\bar{\rho}(\Gamma)}$ be the Zariski closure. Then H is a normal finite-index subgroup of PGL_2 . However, PGL_2 is connected, hence $H = \mathrm{PGL}_2$. ■

Claim. *On the locus of Zariski-dense representations, the restriction*

$$\mathrm{res} : M_B(X, \mathrm{PGL}_2) \rightarrow M_B(X^\epsilon, \mathrm{PGL}_2)$$

is injective on closed points. Consequently, $\mathrm{res}_\epsilon(D)$ has positive-dimensional image in $M_B(X^\epsilon, \mathrm{SL}_2)$.

Proof of Claim. Suppose otherwise, and $\bar{\rho}_1, \bar{\rho}_2$ are Zariski-dense projective representations such that their restrictions to X^ϵ are conjugate. Since $\bar{\rho}_2 \in M_B(X, \mathrm{PGL}_2)$ only depends on conjugacy class, we might assume that $\bar{\rho}_1|_{X^\epsilon} = \bar{\rho}_2|_{X^\epsilon} = \bar{\rho}_\epsilon$. For $\gamma \in \pi_1(X, x)$ and $h \in \ker \epsilon$, denote

$$c_\gamma = \bar{\rho}_2(\gamma)^{-1} \circ \bar{\rho}_1(\gamma) \in \mathrm{PGL}_2$$

and we have, since $\gamma h \gamma^{-1} \in \ker(\epsilon)$,

$$c_\gamma \circ \bar{\rho}_\epsilon(h) \circ c_\gamma^{-1} = \bar{\rho}_\epsilon(h)$$

Now, by the previous claim, $\bar{\rho}_\epsilon$ has Zariski-dense image. Hence the centralizer of $\bar{\rho}_\epsilon(\ker \epsilon)$ agrees with the center $Z(\mathrm{PGL}_2)$ which is trivial. Thus $c_\gamma = \mathrm{Id}$ for all $\gamma \in \pi_1(X, x)$. It follows that

$$\mathrm{res} : M_B(X, \mathrm{PGL}_2) \rightarrow M_B(X^\epsilon, \mathrm{PGL}_2)$$

is injective on closed points. We have a diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{res}_\epsilon} & M_B(X^\epsilon, \mathrm{SL}_2) \\ \mathbb{P} \downarrow & & \downarrow \mathbb{P} \\ M_B(X, \mathrm{PGL}_2) & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{res}} & M_B(X^\epsilon, \mathrm{PGL}_2) \end{array}$$

where both vertical maps are finite, $\mathbb{P}(D)$ is positive dimensional and its general point has Zariski-dense image, hence by the second claim $\mathrm{res} \circ \mathbb{P}(D)$ has positive dimensional image. It follows that $\mathrm{res}_\epsilon(D)$ has positive dimensional image. ■

Thus the general point $\rho_\epsilon \in \text{res}_\epsilon(D)$ is non-rigid. By the diagram, such a general point has $\mathbb{P}(\rho_\epsilon)$ with Zariski-dense image in PGL_2 . On the other hand, let $\overline{\rho_\epsilon(\ker \epsilon)} \subseteq \text{SL}_2$ be the Zariski closure of the image of ρ_ϵ , then $\overline{\rho_\epsilon(\ker \epsilon)} \twoheadrightarrow \text{PGL}_2$. As a result, $\dim \overline{\rho_\epsilon(\ker \epsilon)} \geq 3$ hence $\overline{\rho_\epsilon(\ker \epsilon)} = \text{SL}_2$. $\square$

For a general $\rho \in D$, by Lemma 5.9, the restriction $\rho|_{X^\epsilon}$ has Zariski-dense image and is non-rigid in $M_B(X^\epsilon, \text{SL}_2)$. Hence we have the following as immediate consequences of [CS08]; see also [Sim91, Theorem 10].

Lemma 5.10 ([CS08, Corollary 3.3 and Theorem 6.8]). *For a general $\rho \in D$, the restricted projective representation $\bar{\rho}|_{X^\epsilon}$ factors through an algebraic map $X^\epsilon \rightarrow Y$ where Y is a proper hyperbolic orbicurve.*

To get a factorization for $\bar{\rho}$ instead of $\bar{\rho}|_{X^\epsilon}$ we have the following lemma.

Lemma 5.11 ([CS08, Lemma 3.6]+ ϵ). *Let $f : X' \rightarrow X$ be a finite étale map of smooth projective varieties, and $\bar{\rho} : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \text{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ is a Zariski-dense representation such that $\bar{\rho}|_{X'}$ factors through a proper hyperbolic orbicurve. Then $\bar{\rho}$ itself factors through a proper hyperbolic orbicurve.*

Proof. By taking the Galois closure, we might assume $f : X' \rightarrow X$ is a Galois cover and $X = [X'/G]$. Let $s : X' \rightarrow Y$ be the factorization map for $\bar{\rho}|_{X'}$ with Y proper hyperbolic orbicurve. Let $Y' \rightarrow Y$ be the finite cover by a smooth curve. Replacing X' with $X' \times_Y Y'$ we can assume that the factorization map $s' : X' \rightarrow Y$ has smooth curve target. Take the Stein factorization, and remove from X the closure of the image of all fibers of s' which are reducible or not smooth (passing to an open subset of X is fine by [CS08, Lemma 3.5]). Thus we may assume that all fibers of s' are irreducible, and smooth.

The fibers of s' are maximal subvarieties W of X' such that $\bar{\rho}|_W$ is trivial. For $g \in G = \text{Gal}(X'/X)$, $f \circ g = f$ hence g permutes the fibers of $s' : X' \rightarrow Y$. Hence the G -action descends to Y making s' a G -equivariant map. Thus it descends to $s : X \rightarrow [Y/G]$.

$[Y/G]$ is an orbicurve if and only if the G -action is faithful. Let $I_\eta = \ker(G \rightarrow \text{Aut}(Y))$, then I_η is finite, and a normal subgroup of $\pi_1([Y/G], \bar{y})$. By the previous paragraphs, $\bar{\rho}$ descends to some $\bar{\theta} : \pi_1([Y/G], \bar{y}) \rightarrow \text{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ which must also have Zariski-dense image. Then the normalizer $N_{\text{PGL}_2}(\bar{\theta}(I_\eta))$ contains $\bar{\theta}(\pi_1([Y/G], \bar{y}))$, thus must be PGL_2 . Hence $\bar{\theta}(I_\eta)$ is finite and normal in PGL_2 , which gives that $\bar{\theta}(I_\eta)$ is trivial. We can then replace $[Y/G]$ by $[Y/(G/K)]$ which has trivial generic inertia. $\square$

Corollary 5.12. *For a general $\rho \in D$, the projective representation $\bar{\rho}$ factors through a nonconstant map $s_{\bar{\rho}} : X \rightarrow Y_{\bar{\rho}}$ where $Y_{\bar{\rho}}$ is a proper hyperbolic orbicurve.*

Proof. Apply Lemma 5.11 to the cover $X^\epsilon \rightarrow X$, and use Lemma 5.10 to get factorization on X^ϵ . $\square$

Notice that if we have a finite cover $\pi : Y \rightarrow Y_{\bar{\rho}}$, and a lift $s : X \rightarrow Y$ of $s_{\bar{\rho}}$, then $s_{\bar{\rho}}^* = s^* \circ \pi^*$. Hence $s : X \rightarrow Y$ also satisfies the factorization property. By the following lemma, we can assume that $(s_{\bar{\rho}})_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y_{\bar{\rho}}, y)$ is a surjection.

Lemma 5.13. *Let $s : X \rightarrow Y$ be a nonconstant algebraic morphism from projective connected variety X to a proper hyperbolic orbicurve Y . Then there is a finite étale cover $\pi : Y' \rightarrow Y$ and an algebraic lift $s' : X \rightarrow Y'$ such that s' is surjective and $s'_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y', y')$ is surjective.*

Proof. By [Noo05, Proposition 18.18 and Corollary 18.20] there is a cover $\pi : Y' \rightarrow Y$ corresponding to $\text{im}(s_*) \subseteq \pi_1(Y, y)$, and an analytic lift $s' : X \rightarrow Y'$ with s'_* surjective. Since X is a projective variety and s' is nonconstant, we get that $\text{im}(s') = Y'$, and Y' is also proper. Thus $Y' \rightarrow Y$ is a finite analytic covering map. By [Noo05, Theorem 20.4] this is algebraizable. $\square$

Corollary 5.14. *For a general $\rho \in D$, the projective representation $\bar{\rho}$ factors through a map $s_{\bar{\rho}} : X \rightarrow Y_{\bar{\rho}}$ where $Y_{\bar{\rho}}$ is a proper hyperbolic orbicurve, $s_{\bar{\rho}}$ is surjective, and the induced map $(s_{\bar{\rho}})_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y_{\bar{\rho}}, y)$ is surjective.*

Proposition 5.15. *There is a proper hyperbolic orbicurve Y and an algebraic $s : X \rightarrow Y$ such that $s_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y, y)$ is surjective, and for every $\rho \in D$, the projective representation $\bar{\rho}$ factors through s .*

Proof. By [CS08, Proposition 2.8], there are only finitely many maps $s_j : X \rightarrow Y_j$ with Y_j a hyperbolic orbicurve, and s_j is surjective. By Lemma 5.13, we can assume all $(s_j)_*$ are surjective, thus by Proposition 5.6, we have closed embeddings

$$s_j^* : M_B(Y_j, \text{PGL}_2) \hookrightarrow M_B(X, \text{PGL}_2)$$

Let $\overline{\mathbb{P}(D)}$ be the closure of the image of D under

$$\mathbb{P} : M_B(X, 2) \rightarrow M_B(X, \text{PGL}_2)$$

then by Corollary 5.14, a dense open subset of $\overline{\mathbb{P}(D)}$ must be contained in the finite union $\bigcup_j \text{im}(s_j^*)$ which is Zariski-closed. Hence $\overline{\mathbb{P}(D)} \subseteq \bigcup_j \text{im}(s_j^*)$. Since D is irreducible, so is $\overline{\mathbb{P}(D)}$ and thus must lie entirely in some $\text{im}(s_j^*)$, and we are done. $\square$

Next we recover a factorization for every $\rho \in D$ through the projective factorization. See also [CS08, Lemma 3.1] for the strategy in the case ϵ is trivial, which we will adapt.

Lemma 5.16. *Let Y and s be as in Proposition 5.15. There is a finite gerbe $\mathcal{Y} \rightarrow Y$ and a lift $s_D : X \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ such that $s_{D,*} : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$ is surjective, and every $\rho \in D$ factors through $s_D : X \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$.*

Proof. For $\rho \in D$, notice that $\bar{\rho}$ factors through $s : X \rightarrow Y$ hence $\ker(s_*) \subseteq \ker(\bar{\rho})$. It follows that for every $k \in \ker(s_*)$, $\rho(k)$ is scalar, and we can write

$$\rho(k) = \lambda_\rho(k) \cdot \text{Id}, \quad \lambda_\rho(k)^2 = \det \rho(k) = \epsilon(k)$$

This λ_ρ is independent of $\rho \in D$.

Claim. *There is a $\pi_1(X, x)$ -invariant character $\lambda : \ker(s_*) \rightarrow \mu_{2m}$ such that $\rho(k) = \lambda(k) \cdot \text{Id}$ for every $\rho \in D$ and $k \in \ker(s_*)$.*

Proof of Claim. Indeed, for each $k \in \ker(s_*)$ consider the regular function $f_k \in \mathcal{O}_D(D)$ by

$$f_k(\rho) = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\rho(k))$$

then $f_k(\rho) = \lambda_\rho(k)$, $f_k^2(\rho) = \epsilon(k)$ for all $\rho \in D$. Since $\mathcal{O}_D(D)$ is integral, $f_k(\rho)$ must be constant and equal to one of the two square roots of $\epsilon(k)$; denote this square root $\lambda(k) = f_k$. For $k_1, k_2 \in \ker(s_*)$ and $\rho \in D$,

$$\lambda(k_1 k_2) \cdot \text{Id} = \lambda_\rho(k) \cdot \text{Id} = \rho(k_1 k_2) = \rho(k_1) \rho(k_2) = \lambda(k_1) \lambda(k_2) \cdot \text{Id}$$

hence λ is multiplicative. Similarly, one can check that λ is invariant under conjugation by $\pi_1(X, x)$. Finally, since ϵ is torsion, there is $m \in \mathbb{Z}_+$ such that $\epsilon^m = 1$ hence $\lambda^{2m} = 1$. $\blacksquare$

We thus have a central (since $[\pi_1(X, x), \ker(s_*)] \subseteq \ker(\lambda)$) extension

$$1 \rightarrow \ker(s_*)/\ker(\lambda) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x)/\ker(\lambda) \xrightarrow{s_*} \pi_1(Y, y) \rightarrow 1$$

with $\ker(s_*)/\ker(\lambda) \simeq \text{im}(\lambda)$ finite. By [CS08, Lemma 2.5], this determines a finite $\ker(s_*)/\ker(\lambda)$ -gerbe $\mathcal{Y} \rightarrow Y$ with $\pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y}) = \pi_1(X, x)/\ker(\lambda)$. Furthermore, the quotient $\pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$ is a lift of $s_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y, y)$ which gives a lift $s_D : X \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ of $s : X \rightarrow Y$. By construction, $s_{D,*}$ is surjective. Notice that every $\rho \in D$ has $\rho(\ker(\lambda)) = 1$ hence ρ factors through $\pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$ as desired. $\square$

Proof of Proposition 5.8. By Lemma 5.16 we get a proper hyperbolic DM curve $\mathcal{Y}$ and $s_D : X \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ such that every $\rho \in D$ factors through s_D , i.e. D lies in the image of the closed embedding

$$s_D^* : M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 2) \rightarrow M_B(X, 2)$$

The preimage $(s_D^*)^{-1}(D)$ is irreducible. Furthermore, for every $\psi \in (s_D^*)^{-1}(D)$,

$$s_D^*(\det \psi) = \det(s_D^* \psi) = \epsilon$$

and $s_D^* : M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 1) \hookrightarrow M_B(X, 1)$ is also injective hence $\det(\psi)$ is constant for all $\psi \in (s_D^*)^{-1}(D)$. It follows that $\psi \in (s_D^*)^{-1}(D)$ is irreducible and has fixed-determinant, and thus must lie in a fixed-determinant, fixed-inertia locus by Definition 5.5. Finally, the construction of Lemma 5.11 gives an proper hyperbolic orbicurve of the form $[Y/G]$. The finite gerbe $\mathcal{Y} \rightarrow [Y/G]$ from Lemma 5.16 remains a proper hyperbolic finite quotient curve. $\square$

5.3. $C \rightarrow T$ is either a product or generically finite. Recall (5.1) that we have C an irreducible component of $\Phi_\epsilon^{-1}(Z) \subseteq M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \times A$ with Z an irreducible component of the reduced jump loci $\bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2) \subseteq M_B(X, 2)$. And the two projections give

$$D = \overline{\text{pr}_1(C)}_{\text{red}} \subseteq M_B(X, 2), \quad T = \overline{\text{pr}_2(C)}_{\text{red}} \subseteq A$$

and by Proposition 5.8, there is a proper hyperbolic DM curve $\mathcal{Y} = [Y/G]$ (with Y smooth and G finite), an irreducible component Q of a fixed-determinant, fixed-inertia locus of $M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 2)$ such that, and a map $s : X \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ such that $D \subseteq s^*(Q)$.

Since $C \subseteq D \times T$, and

$$(s^*, \text{id}) : M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 2) \times A \rightarrow M_B(X, 2) \times A$$

is a closed embedding, there is some $\tilde{C} \subseteq Q \times T$ isomorphic to C . We might as well work with $C \subseteq Q \times T$. Denote

$$\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i = \{(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L}) \in Q \times T \mid \dim H^i(s^* \mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{L}) \geq k\}$$

then $C \subseteq \tilde{\Sigma}_k^i$. We start with a decomposition lemma for the proper map $s : X \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$. We have the following diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{\pi'} & X \\ s' \downarrow & & \downarrow s \\ Y & \xrightarrow{\pi} & \mathcal{Y} \end{array} \quad (5.2)$$

where π and π' are both finite étale G -torsor. $X = [X'/G]$, and $s' : X' \rightarrow Y$ is G -equivariant. We have base change for $K \in D_c^b(X, \mathbb{C})$,

$$\pi^* \text{Rs}_* K \simeq \text{Rs}'_*(\pi')^* K$$

Lemma 5.17. *Let $\mathbb{L}$ be a rank one local system on X , then there is G -invariant dense open $j : U \hookrightarrow Y$ and a G -equivariant decomposition*

$$\text{Rs}'_*(\pi')^* \mathbb{L} \simeq \bigoplus_{\alpha} j_* \mathbb{U}_{\alpha}[-a_{\alpha}] \oplus \bigoplus_{\beta} \iota_{\beta,*} \mathcal{V}_{\beta}[-b_{\beta}]$$

where $a_{\alpha}, b_{\beta} \in \mathbb{Z}$, $\mathbb{U}_{\alpha}$ is an irreducible G -equivariant local system on U , and $\mathcal{V}_{\beta}$ is an irreducible local system on the orbit $G \cdot y_{\beta}$ of a point $y_{\beta} \in Y \setminus U$ with G -equivariant inclusion $\iota_{\beta} : G \cdot y_{\beta} \hookrightarrow Y$.

For $\mathbb{W}$ a local system on $\mathcal{Y}$, let $V_{\beta} = (\mathcal{V}_{\beta})_{y_{\beta}}$ and G_{β} the stabilizer of y_{β} . There is a decomposition of cohomology

$$\begin{aligned} H^i(X, s^* \mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{L}) &\simeq \bigoplus_{\alpha} H^{i-a_{\alpha}}(Y, (\pi^* \mathbb{W}) \otimes j_* \mathbb{U}_{\alpha})^G \\ &\quad \oplus \bigoplus_{\beta, b_{\beta}=i} ((\pi^* \mathbb{W})_{y_{\beta}} \otimes V_{\beta})^{G_{\beta}} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. We give a sketch here. $\mathbb{L}' = (\pi')^* \mathbb{L}$ has rank one, and thus is irreducible. By [Sab05, Main Theorem 1], we have a decomposition

$$\text{Rs}'_*(\mathbb{L}'[-\dim X]) \simeq \bigoplus_i {}^p\mathcal{H}^i(\text{Rs}'_*(\mathbb{L}'[-\dim X]))[-i] \quad (5.3)$$

where each ${}^p\mathcal{H}^i(\text{Rs}'_*(\mathbb{L}'[-\dim X]))$ further decomposes into intersection complexes supported on closed irreducible analytic subset of Y . Since Y is a smooth projective curve here, these are either of the form $j_* \mathbb{U}$ where $\mathbb{U}$ is a local system on a Zariski open subset of Y , or skyscraper sheaves.

Notice that $\mathbb{L}' = (\pi')^*\mathbb{L}$ is G -equivariant, and s' is G -equivariant hence the same is true for

$$K := \mathrm{R}s'_*(\mathbb{L}'[-\dim X])$$

For $g \in G$, $g : Y \rightarrow Y$ is an isomorphism hence g^* preserves perverse t-structure. Thus the truncation triangle

$${}^p\tau_{\leq i-1}K \rightarrow {}^p\tau_{\leq i}K \rightarrow {}^p\mathcal{H}^i(K) \rightarrow {}^p\tau_{\leq i-1}K[1] \quad (5.4)$$

is also G -equivariant. Sabbah's decomposition (5.3) gives a splitting of this triangle. Since G is finite, by averaging we get a G -equivariant splitting. Thus we might assume that (5.3) is G -equivariant. Each ${}^p\mathcal{H}^i(K)$ is G -equivariant, hence the G -action will permute the skyscraper sheaves. Thus the skyscraper sheaves come in G -orbits, as stated in the lemma.

Next, the full-support part of ${}^p\mathcal{H}^i(K)$ has to look like $j_{0,*}(\mathbb{U}_0[1])$ for some semisimple local system $\mathbb{U}_0$ on Zariski open $j_0 : U_0 \hookrightarrow Y$. Let $U \subseteq U_0$ be a G -invariant Zariski open subset of Y with G -equivariant inclusion $j : U \hookrightarrow Y$, and put

$$\mathbb{U} = \mathcal{H}^{-1}(j^{-1}j_{0,*}(\mathbb{U}_0[1])) \simeq \mathbb{U}_0|_U$$

then $\mathbb{U}$ is a G -equivariant local system on U . It is semisimple since $\pi_1(U_0) \twoheadrightarrow \pi_1(U)$. By uniqueness of intermediate extension, we get a G -equivariant isomorphism

$$j_*(\mathbb{U}[1]) \simeq j_{0,*}(\mathbb{U}_0[1])$$

For the cohomology statement, by projection formula we have

$$\begin{aligned} H^i(X, s^*\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{L}) &\simeq H^i(X', (\pi')^*s^*\mathbb{W} \otimes (\pi')^*\mathbb{L})^G \\ &\simeq H^i(X', (s')^*\pi^*\mathbb{W} \otimes (\pi')^*\mathbb{L})^G \\ &\simeq \mathbb{H}^i(Y, \pi^*\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathrm{R}(s')_*(\pi')^*\mathbb{L})^G \end{aligned}$$

and we can apply the decomposition of $\mathrm{R}(s')_*(\pi')^*\mathbb{L}$ to conclude. $\square$

Proposition 5.18. *C is an irreducible component of $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i$. For every $\mathbb{L} \in T$, the fiber $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i|_{\mathbb{L}}$ is either Q , a finite set, or empty. Consequently, $C = Q \times T$, or $C \rightarrow T$ is generically finite.*

Proof. If an irreducible component C' of $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i$ contains C , then

$$Z = \Phi_\epsilon(C) \subseteq \Phi_\epsilon(C') \subseteq \bar{\Sigma}_k^i(X, 2)$$

and Φ_ϵ is finite hence $\Phi_\epsilon(C')$ is irreducible. But Z is an irreducible component, hence $Z = \Phi_\epsilon(C')$. Finiteness then gives $\dim C = \dim C'$ thus $C = C'$.

Next, recall that the fiber $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i|_{\mathbb{L}}$ is the locus

$$\{\mathbb{W} \in Q \mid \dim H^i(s^*\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{L}) \geq k\}$$

and by Lemma 5.17, it suffices to look at the jumping behavior of each

$$H^{i-a}(Y, (\pi^*\mathbb{W}) \otimes j_*\mathbb{U})^G, \quad ((\pi^*\mathbb{W})_y \otimes V)^{G_y}$$

with $j : U \hookrightarrow Y$ the inclusion of a G -invariant open, $\mathbb{U}$ an irreducible G -equivariant local system on U , $y \in Y \setminus U$ with G_y the stabilizer, and V an irreducible G_y -representation. Notice that $j : U \rightarrow Y$, $\mathbb{U}$, G_y and V do not depend on $\mathbb{W}$. Also, since Y is a smooth curve, $H^{i-a} = 0$ unless $0 \leq i - a \leq 2$.

Claim. *The G_y -representation $(\pi^*\mathbb{W})_y$ does not depend on $\mathbb{W}$. Consequently,*

$$\dim((\pi^*\mathbb{W})_y \otimes V)^{G_y}$$

is constant as $\mathbb{W}$ varies in Q .

Proof of Claim. We have injective $G_y \hookrightarrow \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$ hence each $g \in G_y$ determines an element of $\gamma_g \in \pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$. Thus it induces a regular function on Q

$$\mathbb{W} \mapsto \text{tr}(g|_{(\pi^*\mathbb{W})_y}) = \text{tr}(\rho_{\mathbb{W}}(\gamma_g))$$

where $\rho_{\mathbb{W}}$ is the $\pi_1(\mathcal{Y}, \bar{y})$ -representation corresponding to $\mathbb{W}$. Since G_y is finite, the function defined above has discrete image. Since Q is irreducible, it must be constant. It follows that all G_y -representations $(\pi^*\mathbb{W})_y$, as $\mathbb{W}$ varies in Q , have the same characters hence must be isomorphic. $\blacksquare$

Moving on, notice that $(\pi^*\mathbb{W}) \otimes j_*\mathbb{U} = j_*((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U \otimes \mathbb{U})$, and denote

$$h_G^l(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) = \dim H^l(Y, j_*((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U \otimes \mathbb{U}))^G$$

and $\chi_G(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) = h_G^0(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) - h_G^1(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) + h_G^2(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})$.

Claim. *$\chi_G(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})$ is constant as $\mathbb{W}$ varies in Q .*

Proof of Claim. Let $\bar{Y} = Y/G$ be the coarse space for $[Y/G]$, with the quotient $q : Y \rightarrow \bar{Y}$ which is a finite map. Denote the constructible sheaf

$$\mathcal{L}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) := j_*((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U \otimes \mathbb{U}), \quad \bar{\mathcal{L}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) := (q_*\mathcal{L}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}))^G$$

then $H^l(Y, \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}))^G \simeq H^l(\bar{Y}, \bar{\mathcal{L}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}))$. Denote $I_\eta = \ker(G \rightarrow \text{Aut}(Y))$ the generic inertia. Denote $E \subset \bar{Y}$ a finite set of points, consisting of $q(Y \setminus U)$ and images of points on Y with larger than generic stabilizer. Then $\bar{\mathcal{L}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})|_{\bar{Y} \setminus E}$ is a local system of dimension

$$r(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) = \dim((\pi^*\mathbb{W})_y \otimes \mathbb{U}_y)^{G_y} = \dim((\pi^*\mathbb{W})_y \otimes \mathbb{U}_y)^{I_\eta}, \quad y \in q^{-1}(\bar{Y} \setminus E)$$

and for $z \in E$, $\bar{\mathcal{L}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})|_z$ is a vector space of dimension

$$\dim((\pi^*\mathbb{W})_y \otimes \mathbb{U}_y)^{G_y}, \quad y \in q^{-1}(z)$$

By the same argument as in previous claim, both of these values are constant as $\mathbb{W}$ varies in Q . On the other hand, since compactly supported Euler characteristic is additive for the stratification $\bar{Y} = E \sqcup (\bar{Y} \setminus E)$ we get that

$$\begin{aligned} \chi_G(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) &= \chi(\bar{Y}, \bar{\mathcal{L}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})) \\ &= \chi_c(\bar{Y} \setminus E, \bar{\mathcal{L}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})|_{\bar{Y} \setminus E}) + \sum_{z \in E} \dim \bar{\mathcal{L}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})|_z \\ &= \chi_c(\bar{Y} \setminus E) \cdot r(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) + \sum_{z \in E} \dim \bar{\mathcal{L}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})|_z \end{aligned}$$

$$= (2 - 2g(\bar{Y}) - |E|) \cdot r(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) + \sum_{z \in E} \dim \bar{\mathcal{L}}(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})|_z$$

which is constant as $\mathbb{W}$ varies in Q , as desired. $\blacksquare$

Next, we examine these cohomology groups more explicitly:

$$\begin{aligned} H^0(Y, j_*((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U \otimes \mathbb{U}))^G &\simeq H^0(U, (\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U \otimes \mathbb{U})^G \\ &\simeq \text{Hom}_{\text{Loc}^G(U)}(\mathbb{U}^\vee, (\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U) \end{aligned}$$

and by Poincaré duality [Dim04, Corollary 3.3.12]

$$H^2(Y, j_*((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U \otimes \mathbb{U}))^G \simeq \text{Hom}_{\text{Loc}^G(U)}((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U, \mathbb{U}^\vee)^\vee$$

Since $\mathbb{W}$ is semisimple on $\mathcal{Y}$, $\pi^*\mathbb{W}$ is semisimple in $\text{Loc}^G(Y)$. Thus $(\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U$ is semisimple in $\text{Loc}^G(U)$. It follows that the two cohomology groups above both count the multiplicities of $\mathbb{U}^\vee$ in $(\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U$ and $h_G^0(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) = h_G^2(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U})$.

Claim. $h_G^0(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) \neq 0$ for only finitely many $\mathbb{W} \in Q$.

Proof of Claim. The observation which will be used throughout is that the functor

$$\text{Loc}(\mathcal{Y}) \rightarrow \text{Loc}_G(U), \quad \mathbb{W} \mapsto (\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U$$

is fully faithful. If $\mathbb{U}$ has rank ≥ 2 , then if $h_G^0(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) \neq 0$ we must have $(\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U \simeq \mathbb{U}^\vee$. There is at most one such $\mathbb{W} \in Q$.

Now suppose $\mathbb{U}$ has rank 1. If $h_G^0(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) \neq 0$ then $\mathbb{U}^\vee$ must be a summand of $(\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U$ and $(\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U$ must be reducible in $\text{Loc}^G(U)$. It follows that $(\pi^*\mathbb{W})$ must be reducible in $\text{Loc}^G(Y)$. Since $\mathbb{W} \in Q$, $s^*\mathbb{W} \in D \subset M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon)$, with $s^* : M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 1) \hookrightarrow M_B(X, 1)$ a closed embedding, we get that $\pi^*\mathbb{W}$ has fixed determinant $s^*\epsilon$. It follows that

$$\pi^*\mathbb{W} \simeq \mathbb{M} \oplus (\mathbb{M}^\vee \otimes s^*\epsilon)$$

and $\mathbb{U}^\vee = \mathbb{M}$ or $\mathbb{M}^\vee \otimes s^*\epsilon$. Again, finitely many $\mathbb{W}$ giving this. $\blacksquare$

Each $\mathbb{U}$ in Lemma 5.17 gives a finite set of $\mathbb{W} \in Q$ where $h_G^0(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) \neq 0$. Take $F(\mathbb{L})$ to be the union as $\mathbb{U}$ runs over all the finitely many summands in the decomposition of $\text{Rs}'_*(\pi')^*\mathbb{L}$, then $F(\mathbb{L})$ is also finite. To summarize, for a fixed $\mathbb{L}$

$$\dim H^0(Y, (\pi^*\mathbb{W}) \otimes j_*\mathbb{U})^G = h_G^0(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) = 0 \quad \forall \mathbb{W} \in Q \setminus F(\mathbb{L})$$

$$\dim H^2(Y, (\pi^*\mathbb{W}) \otimes j_*\mathbb{U})^G = h_G^2(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) = h_G^0(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) \quad \forall \mathbb{W} \in Q \setminus F(\mathbb{L})$$

and thus for all $\mathbb{W} \in Q \setminus F(\mathbb{L})$,

$$\begin{aligned} \dim H^1(Y, (\pi^*\mathbb{W}) \otimes j_*\mathbb{U})^G &= -\chi_G(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) + 2h_G^0(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) \\ &= -\chi_G(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{U}) \end{aligned}$$

which is constant for $\mathbb{W} \in Q$. It follows that there is a constant $k_{\mathbb{L}}$ such that

$$\dim H^i(X, s^*\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{L}) = k_{\mathbb{L}} \quad \forall \mathbb{W} \in Q \setminus F(\mathbb{L}) \quad (5.5)$$

$$\dim H^i(X, s^*\mathbb{W} \otimes \mathbb{L}) \geq k_{\mathbb{L}} \quad \forall \mathbb{W} \in Q \quad (5.6)$$

and consequently we have proven:

Claim. *For every $\mathbb{L} \in T$, the fiber $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i|_{\mathbb{L}}$ is either Q , finite, or empty.*

Back to $C \subseteq \tilde{\Sigma}_k^i \subseteq Q \times T$. The map $C \rightarrow T$ is dominant by definition. Here we can assume $\dim Q > 0$ by [Remark 5.7](#). Suppose that the general fiber of $C \rightarrow T$ has positive dimension, then on a Zariski open subset $T^\circ \subseteq T$, since $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i \supset C$, $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i|_{\mathbb{L}}$ has fiber Q . Hence,

$$Q \times T^\circ \subset \tilde{\Sigma}_k^i \subset Q \times T$$

and since $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i$ is closed, we get $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i = Q \times T$. This is irreducible, so $C = Q \times T$. The other case is that $C \rightarrow T$ is generically finite. $\square$

5.4. Finiteness of $C \rightarrow T$. In this section, we will prove that if $C \xrightarrow{\text{pr}_2} T$ is generically finite, then it must in fact be finite. To differentiate, let the G -invariant dense open in [Lemma 5.17](#) be denoted $j_{\mathbb{L}} : U_{\mathbb{L}} \hookrightarrow Y$ for the decomposition of $R s'_*(\pi')^*\mathbb{L}$. Also denote $\mathbb{L}' = (\pi')^*\mathbb{L}$.

For $U \subseteq Y$ a G -equivariant Zariski open subset, we have a diagram by restricting [\(5.2\)](#)

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X'_U & \xrightarrow{\pi'_U} & X_U \\ s'_U \downarrow & & \downarrow s_U \\ U & \xrightarrow{\pi_U} & [U/G] \end{array}$$

and we can pick U so that the map $s'_U : X'_U \rightarrow U$ is smooth and proper. Then

$$\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^m = R^m(s'_U)_*(\mathbb{L}'|_{X'_U}) \quad (5.7)$$

is a G -equivariant local system on U .

Lemma 5.19. *Let $\mathbb{L} \in T$, and suppose that the fiber $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i|_{\mathbb{L}}$ is finite. Let $(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L}) \in C \subseteq \tilde{\Sigma}_k^i$ with $\mathbb{W}$ irreducible in $\text{Loc}(\mathcal{Y})$, then, for some m , there is a quotient*

$$\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^m \rightarrow ((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U)^\vee$$

in $\text{Loc}^G(U)$. In fact, $(\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U^\vee$ is a direct summand of $\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^m$.

Proof. Look at the G -equivariant decomposition of [Lemma 5.17](#),

$$R(s'_*)\mathbb{L}' \simeq \bigoplus_{\alpha} j_{\mathbb{L},*}\mathbb{U}_{\alpha}[-a_{\alpha}] \oplus \bigoplus_{\beta} \iota_{\beta,*}\mathcal{V}_{\beta}[-b_{\beta}] \quad (5.8)$$

with $\mathbb{U}_{\alpha}$ irreducible in $\text{Loc}^G(U_{\mathbb{L}})$. By the proof of [Proposition 5.18](#) (see in particular the paragraphs around [\(5.5\)](#)), if $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i|_{\mathbb{L}}$ is finite, then it consists of points $(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L})$ such that

$$\dim H^0(Y, (\pi^*\mathbb{W}) \otimes j_{\mathbb{L},*}\mathbb{U}_{\alpha})^G > 0$$

which implies that $\text{Hom}_{\text{Loc}^G(U_{\mathbb{L}})}(\mathbb{U}_{\alpha}^\vee, (\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_{U_{\mathbb{L}}}) > 0$. Since $\mathbb{W} \mapsto (\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_{U_{\mathbb{L}}}$ is a fully faithful functor which preserves irreducibility, we have that

$$\mathbb{U}_{\alpha} \simeq ((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_{U_{\mathbb{L}}})^\vee \quad \text{in } \text{Loc}^G(U_{\mathbb{L}})$$

Next, by restricting the decomposition (5.8) to U we get that $(j_{\mathbb{L},*}\mathbb{U}_\alpha)|_U$ is a direct summand of $\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^{a_\alpha}$ in $\mathrm{Loc}^G(U)$; in particular, $(j_{\mathbb{L},*}\mathbb{U}_\alpha)|_U$ is a local system on U . The previous argument show that

$$(j_{\mathbb{L},*}\mathbb{U}_\alpha)|_{U \cap U_{\mathbb{L}}} \simeq \mathbb{U}_\alpha|_{U \cap U_{\mathbb{L}}} \simeq ((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_{U \cap U_{\mathbb{L}}})^\vee$$

and since restriction $\mathrm{Loc}^G(U) \rightarrow \mathrm{Loc}^G(U \cap U_{\mathbb{L}})$ is fully faithful, we get that

$$(j_{\mathbb{L},*}\mathbb{U}_\alpha)|_U \simeq ((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U)^\vee \quad \text{in } \mathrm{Loc}^G(U)$$

and thus $((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U)^\vee$ is a direct summand of $\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^{a_\alpha}$. Since $\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^{a_\alpha}$ is semisimple we get the quotient statement as well. $\square$

Let $\mathcal{O}(T) = \Gamma(T, \mathcal{O}_T)$. Pulling back the universal rank 1 local system along $T \subseteq M_B(X, 1)$ we get $\mathbb{L}_{\mathrm{univ}}$ a local system of free $\mathcal{O}(T)$ -modules on X . For $\mathbb{L} \in T$,

$$\mathbb{L}_{\mathrm{univ}} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}(T)} \kappa(\mathbb{L}) \simeq \mathbb{L}$$

where we are taking tensor products with, and over, constant local systems on X . Again, denote $\mathbb{L}'_{\mathrm{univ}} = (\pi')^*\mathbb{L}_{\mathrm{univ}}$, then $\mathbb{L}'_{\mathrm{univ}}$ is a G -equivariant local system of $\mathcal{O}(T)$ -modules on X' (the G -action on T is trivial). We also have that

$$\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{univ}}^m = R^m(s'_U)_*(\mathbb{L}'_{\mathrm{univ}}|_{X'_U})$$

is a G -equivariant local system of $\mathcal{O}(T)$ -modules on U , since s'_U is a smooth and proper G -equivariant map. Equivalently, fixing $u \in U$ with $\bar{u}$ the image in $[U/G]$, $(\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{univ}}^m)_u$ is a $\mathcal{O}(T)$ -module, and we have a $\mathcal{O}(T)$ -linear representation

$$\pi_1([U/G], \bar{u}) \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_{\mathcal{O}(T)}((\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{univ}}^m)_u)$$

On the other hand, we can also think of $(\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{univ}}^m)_u$ as a $\mathcal{O}_T$ -module on T . There is then a Zariski dense open $T^{\mathrm{bc}} \subseteq T$ where cohomology and base change is available, i.e., for $\mathbb{L} \in T^{\mathrm{bc}}$, there is an isomorphisms of $\pi_1([U/G], \bar{u})$ -representations

$$(\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{univ}}^m)_u \otimes \kappa(\mathbb{L}) \simeq (\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^m)_u$$

with $\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^m$ defined in (5.7).

Remark 5.20. By Lemma 5.19, a point $(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L})$ in a finite fiber of $C \rightarrow T$ with $\mathbb{L} \in T^{\mathrm{bc}}$ and $\mathbb{W}$ irreducible correspond to a rank two quotient

$$(\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{univ}}^m)_u \otimes \kappa(\mathbb{L}) \twoheadrightarrow ((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U)_u^\vee$$

as $\pi_1([U/G], \bar{u})$ -representations.

Proposition 5.21 ([HS04, Corollary 2.4]). *Let T be an affine noetherian variety, $\mathcal{H}$ a coherent $\mathcal{O}_T$ -module, and Π a finitely generated group. Suppose that there is a $\mathcal{O}_T$ -linear action of Π on $\mathcal{H}$. The functor assigning to an affine T -scheme $\phi : S \rightarrow T$ the set*

$$\{\Pi - \text{invariant locally free rank 2 quotients of } \phi^*\mathcal{H}\}$$

is representable by a projective T -scheme.

Proof. Since we are on affine schemes, we will abuse notation between sheaves and modules. Denote the $\mathcal{O}(T)$ -linear action of Π on $\mathcal{H}$ by

$$\rho : \Pi \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_{\mathcal{O}(T)}(\mathcal{H})$$

then our functor assigns to a commutative $\mathcal{O}(T)$ -algebra R the set of $\rho(\Pi)$ -invariant locally free R -module quotients of $\mathcal{H} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}(T)} R$. To apply the cited result, let $k = \mathcal{O}(T)$, A be the singleton set, $T = \mathcal{H}$, and $F = \rho(\Pi)$. $\square$

Apply the previous proposition to $\Pi = \pi_1([U/G], \bar{u})$ and $\mathcal{H} = (\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{univ}}^m)_u$. Let the resulting projective T -scheme be denoted $\mathcal{G}_m$. Notice that a closed point of $\mathcal{G}_m$, over $\mathbb{L} \in T^{\mathrm{bc}}$, is a $\pi_1([U/G], \bar{u})$ -invariant quotient of $(\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{univ}}^m)_u \otimes \kappa(\mathbb{L}) \simeq (\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^m)_u$. If $\mathbb{L} \notin T^{\mathrm{bc}}$ then the quotient is still a rank 2 $\pi_1([U/G], \bar{u})$ -representation. We have a natural map over T

$$\Phi_m : \mathcal{G}_m \rightarrow M_B([U/G], 2) \times T, \quad [(\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{univ}}^m)_u \otimes \kappa(\mathbb{L}) \twoheadrightarrow \mathbb{V}] \mapsto ([\mathbb{V}^\vee], \mathbb{L})$$

which has image finite over T since $M_B([U/G], 2)$ is affine.

Proposition 5.22. *There is a closed subscheme $\mathcal{F}_Q \subset Q \times T$, finite over T , with the following property: if $\mathbb{W} \in Q$ and $\mathbb{L} \in T^{\mathrm{bc}}$, and $((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U)^\vee$ is a rank two G -equivariant quotient of $\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^m$ for some m , then $(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L}) \in \mathcal{F}_Q$.*

Proof. Denote the disjoint union

$$\mathcal{G} = \bigsqcup_{m=0}^{2 \dim X - 1} \mathcal{G}_m$$

and let $\mathcal{F}$ be the image of $\Phi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow M_B([U/G], 2) \times T$. Then $\mathcal{F}$ is finite over T . We have a closed embedding

$$M_B(\mathcal{Y}, 2) \hookrightarrow M_B([U/G], 2), \quad \mathbb{W} \mapsto (\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U$$

hence we can view $Q \times T$ as a closed subscheme of $M_B([U/G], 2) \times T$, and define

$$\mathcal{F}_Q := \mathcal{F} \times_{M_B([U/G], 2) \times T} (Q \times T)$$

which is finite over T . On the other hand, a point $(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L})$ with $\mathbb{L} \in T^{\mathrm{bc}}$ and $((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U)^\vee$ is a rank two G -equivariant quotient of $\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^m$ for some m must be in the image of Φ_m by [Remark 5.20](#). As a result it must be in $\mathcal{F}_Q$. $\square$

Proposition 5.23. *If $\mathrm{pr}_2 : C \rightarrow T$ is generically finite, then it must be finite and surjective.*

Proof. There is an Zariski open subset $T^\circ \subseteq T$ such that

- $T^\circ \subseteq T^{\mathrm{bc}}$;
- $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i|_{\mathbb{L}}$ is finite or empty for every $\mathbb{L} \in T^\circ$;
- every $(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L}) \in C$ with $\mathbb{L} \in T^\circ$ has $\mathbb{W}$ irreducible.

Let $(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L})$ be a closed point of $C \times_T T^\circ$. Then $\tilde{\Sigma}_k^i|_{\mathbb{L}}$ is a finite fiber. By [Lemma 5.19](#) we get a quotient

$$\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{L}}^m \twoheadrightarrow ((\pi^*\mathbb{W})|_U)^\vee$$

for some m . By [Proposition 5.22](#), $(\mathbb{W}, \mathbb{L}) \in \mathcal{F}_Q$. It follows that

$$C \times_T T^\circ \subseteq \mathcal{F}_Q$$

On the other hand, since pr_2 is dominant, $C \times_T T^\circ$ is dense in C . Taking closures in $Q \times T$ then gives C is a closed subscheme of $\mathcal{F}_Q$. Since $\mathcal{F}_Q$ is finite over T , we get that $C \rightarrow T$ is finite. Since it is dominant, it must be surjective as well. $\square$

5.5. Étaleness of $C^\nu \rightarrow T$. We have that $\text{pr}_2 : C \rightarrow T$ is finite. Let $\nu : C^\nu \rightarrow C$ be the normalization, and $\text{pr}_2' := \text{pr}_2 \circ \nu : C^\nu \rightarrow T$. Then pr_2' is also finite and surjective. Let $C^{\text{ét}} \subseteq C$ be Zariski open locus where pr_2 is étale, and denote

$$\Delta(\text{pr}_2) := \text{pr}_2(C \setminus C^{\text{ét}})_{\text{red}} \subset T$$

which is closed in T .

Lemma 5.24. *The set $\Delta(\text{pr}_2)$ is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed in A .*

Proof. See (5.1) for the setup. By the first paragraph of the proof of [Corollary 3.10](#), but with M_B , we have that $C \subseteq M_B(X, 2, \det = \epsilon) \times A$ and $T \subseteq A$ are both absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed. In the notation of [Definition 2.15](#), C^σ and T^σ are both $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed for any $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(\mathbb{C}/\mathbb{Q})$. By [\[Sim94, Proposition 7.8\]](#) we have an analytic isomorphism

$$\text{RH} : M_{\text{DR}}(X, r)^{\text{an}} \xrightarrow{\sim} M_B(X, r)^{\text{an}}$$

and $C_{\text{DR}} = \text{RH}^{-1}(C)$, $T_{\text{DR}} = \text{RH}^{-1}(T)$ are both algebraic by [\[BW20, Proposition 7.4.5\]](#). We also have diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (C_{\text{DR}})^{\text{an}} & \xrightarrow{(\text{pr}_{\text{DR},2})^{\text{an}}} & (T_{\text{DR}})^{\text{an}} \\ \downarrow \text{RH} & & \downarrow \text{RH} \\ C^{\text{an}} & \xrightarrow{(\text{pr}_2)^{\text{an}}} & T^{\text{an}} \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{ccc} (C_{\text{DR}}^\sigma)^{\text{an}} & \xrightarrow{(\text{pr}_{\text{DR},2}^\sigma)^{\text{an}}} & (T_{\text{DR}}^\sigma)^{\text{an}} \\ \downarrow \text{RH} & & \downarrow \text{RH} \\ (C^\sigma)^{\text{an}} & \xrightarrow{(\text{pr}_2^\sigma)^{\text{an}}} & (T^\sigma)^{\text{an}} \end{array} \quad (5.9)$$

where $(\text{pr}_{\text{DR},2}^\sigma)^{\text{an}}$ is induced by $(\text{pr}_{\text{DR},2})^{\text{an}}$ through an isomorphism of schemes

$$\sigma : M_{\text{DR}}(X, r) \xrightarrow{\sim} M_{\text{DR}}(X^\sigma, r)$$

which is itself the pullback along the base change $X^\sigma \rightarrow X$.

We have that analytification detects étaleness [\[Sta26, Last paragraph of Tag 025L\]](#), i.e. an algebraic map is étale if and only if its analytification is a local isomorphism. We also have that $(\text{pr}_{\text{DR},2}^\sigma)^{\text{an}}$ is a local isomorphism if and only if $(\text{pr}_{\text{DR},2})^{\text{an}}$ is one. It follows that $\Delta(\text{pr}_2)^\sigma = \Delta(\text{pr}_2^\sigma)$. Thus $\Delta(\text{pr}_2)$ is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed. $\square$

Lemma 5.25. *If pr_2' is not étale, then there is a prime divisor $E \subset C^\nu$ such that pr_2' is ramified at the generic point η_E of E . Furthermore, $\text{pr}_2'(E)$ is an irreducible component of $\Delta(\text{pr}_2)$.*

Proof. The existence of η_E follows from (5) of [\[Sta26, Tag 0BMB\]](#) since pr_2' satisfies all (1-4). Since pr_2' is ramified at η_E , pr_2 must not be étale at $\nu(\eta_E)$ because otherwise C is smooth at $\nu(\eta_E)$ (since T is smooth) and ν is an isomorphism at η_E . Thus

$\mathrm{pr}_2''(E) \subseteq \Delta(\mathrm{pr}_2)$. A finite map preserves dimensions, so $\mathrm{pr}_2''(E)$ is a prime divisor in T hence must be an irreducible component of $\Delta(\mathrm{pr}_2)$. $\square$

Proposition 5.26. *The finite map $\mathrm{pr}_2'' : C^\nu \rightarrow T$ is étale.*

Proof. Suppose otherwise, then by Lemma 5.25 we get a prime divisor $E \subset C^\nu$ such that pr_2'' is ramified at every point of E , and $\mathrm{pr}_2''(E) = T_0$ is an irreducible component of $\Delta(\mathrm{pr}_2)$. Since $\Delta(\mathrm{pr}_2)$ is absolute $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ -closed, the same is true for T_0 and by Theorem 2.16, T_0 is a torsion-translated subtorus of A .

Since C^ν is normal, the singular locus is codimension 2, and C^ν is smooth on a Zariski open subset of E . T_0 is a torsion-translated subtorus, hence unitary points are Zariski dense in T_0 . It follows that there exists a point $c \in E \subset C^\nu$ lying over $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})$ such that $\mathrm{pr}_2''(c) = \mathbb{L} \in T_0$ is unitary. We have a $\mathbb{C}^*$ -action on $M_B(X, 2) \times A \supset C$. Now, C is the good moduli image of a Hodge substack of $M_B(X, 2) \times A$, hence by [BBT24, Corollary 8.24], C is $\mathbb{C}^*$ -stable. Now look at the $\mathbb{C}^*$ -orbit of $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})$. Since $\mathbb{L}$ is unitary, it is $\mathbb{C}^*$ -fixed, hence the image under pr_2 of this orbit is just $\mathbb{L}$. But $\mathrm{pr}_2 : C \rightarrow T$ is finite, so the $\mathbb{C}^*$ -orbit is finite, thus $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})$ must be $\mathbb{C}^*$ -fixed to begin with. To summarize, we have $c \in C^\nu$ a smooth point lying over $(\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L})$ with both $\mathbb{V}, \mathbb{L}$ underlying weight 0 variation of complex Hodge structures. By Corollary 3.17 and Corollary 3.12 we get a morphism of pro- $\mathbf{T}(0)$ -MHS-algebras

$$\mathrm{pr}_{2,c}^{\nu,\#} : \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T,\mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C,(\mathbb{V},\mathbb{L})} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu,c}$$

which is a finite local map between regular complete local rings of the same dimension. By [Sta26, Tag 00R4] it must be flat, hence faithfully flat. In particular $\mathrm{pr}_{2,c}^{\nu,\#}$ is injective. Next look at the map on cotangent spaces

$$d(\mathrm{pr}_2'')_c^\vee : \mathfrak{m}_{T,\mathbb{L}}/\mathfrak{m}_{T,\mathbb{L}}^2 \rightarrow \mathfrak{m}_{C^\nu,c}/\mathfrak{m}_{C^\nu,c}^2$$

which must have nontrivial kernel since pr_2'' is ramified at c . Take the functorial Deligne weight splitting (similar to the proof of Lemma 3.13) to talk about homogeneous elements. Notice that $\mathfrak{m}_{T,\mathbb{L}}/\mathfrak{m}_{T,\mathbb{L}}^2$ is pure of weight -1 . Pick a homogeneous weight -1 element in the kernel of $d(\mathrm{pr}_2'')_c^\vee$. Its image must either be 0 or also homogeneous of weight -1 . The latter is impossible since $\mathfrak{m}_{C^\nu,c}^2 \subseteq W_{-2}\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu,c}$, and the former is also impossible since $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{T,\mathbb{L}} \rightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{C^\nu,c}$ is injective. Thus we reach a contradiction, and $\mathrm{pr}_2'' : C^\nu \rightarrow T$ is étale. $\square$

Corollary 5.27. *C^ν is an algebraic torus.*

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DEPARTMENT OF MATHEMATICS, UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO, CHICAGO, ILLINOIS, USA

Email address: quocanh@uchicago.edu

URL: <https://quocanh-tran.github.io/>